

Ancient History

Teaching tables, Confused Pairs, Common Traps, Current Affairs, and other high-yield blocks.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

Chapters

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Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events

Consolidated — 28 Must-Score Facts

1. Culture ladder: **Palaeolithic** → **Mesolithic** → **Neolithic** → **Chalcolithic** → **Iron Age / NBPW**.
2. Harappan: **Early c. 3300–2600** → **Mature c. 2600–1900** → **Late c. 1900–1300 BCE**.
3. Vedic: **Early / Rigvedic c. 1500–1000** → **Later Vedic c. 1000–600 BCE**.
4. Religious founders (traditional coaching dates): **Mahavira c. 599–527 BCE**; **Buddha c. 563–483 BCE**.
5. Magadha dynasties: **Haryanka** → **Shishunaga** → **Nanda** → **Maurya**.
6. Magadha kings: **Bimbisara** → **Ajatashatru** (Haryanka peak) → **Udayin** (Pataliputra capital) → **Shishunaga** (takes Avanti) → **Mahapadma / Dhana Nanda**.
7. **Alexander 326–325 BCE** (Hydaspes vs Porus; mutiny at Beas) → **Chandragupta Maurya c. 321 BCE**.
8. Maurya spine: **Chandragupta** → **Bindusara** → **Ashoka (c. 268–232)** → **decline** → **Pushyamitra Shunga 185 BCE**.
9. **Kalinga War c. 261 BCE** — Ashoka's turning point to Dhamma; **Third Council c. 250 BCE** at Pataliputra.
10. Post-Mauryan: **Shunga** → **Kanva**; Deccan **Satavahana**; NW **Indo-Greek** → **Shaka** → **Parthian** → **Kushana**.
11. Eras: **Vikrama 57 BCE**; **Saka 78 CE** (Kanishka-linked). Difference = **135 years**.
12. Kushana peak: **Kujula** → **Vima (gold)** → **Kanishka** (Fourth Council, Kashmir / Kundalvana tradition).
13. Gupta Era begins **c. 319–320 CE** with **Chandragupta I** (first *Maharajadhiraja*).
14. Gupta spine: **Chandragupta I** → **Samudragupta** → **Chandragupta II** → **Kumaragupta I** → **Skandagupta**.
15. Pilgrims: **Fa-Hien** under Chandragupta II (~399–414); **Xuanzang** under Harsha (~630–644); **I-tsing** after Harsha (~671–695).
16. Science tags: **Aryabhata** (born **476 CE**); **Varahamihira**; **Brahmagupta 628 CE**.
17. **Harsha 606–647 CE**; defeated on the Narmada by **Pulakeshin II** (Aihole / Ravikirti).
18. South spine: **Sangam** → **Satavahana** → **Pallava** → **Badami Chalukya** → **Rashtrakuta** → **Imperial Chola** (later = Medieval).
19. Do not swap **Fa-Hien / Xuanzang** or **Chandragupta Maurya / Chandragupta I / Chandragupta II**.
20. Do not swap **First Buddhist Council (Rajagriha)** with **Third (Pataliputra / Ashoka)** or **Fourth (Kanishka)**.
21. Pottery clock: **OCP** → **PGW** → **NBPW** sits beside the culture ladder for doab stems.
22. Invader order into NW India: **Greeks** → **Sakas** → **Kushans** (Parthians bridge Shaka and Kushan).
23. Seleucus–Chandragupta treaty ~**305–303 BCE** (500 elephants; Megasthenes). Diadochi **Ipsus 301 BCE**.
24. Huna check: **Toramana** → **Mihirakula**; **Yashodharman** of Malwa at Mandasor ~**532 CE**.
25. Harsha capitals: early **Thanesar** → later **Kannauj**; Chinese title **Siladitya**.
26. Sangam Muvendar: **Chera–Vanji**, **Chola–Uraiyur**, **Pandya–Madurai**; Karikala's **Kallanai**.
27. Key inscription pegs: **Hathigumpha** (Kharavela), **Junagadh** (Rudradaman), **Prayag Prashasti** (Samudragupta / Harishena), **Aihole** (Pulakeshin II).
28. UP chronological anchors: Belan Neolithic → Alamgirpur / Sanauli fringe → Later Vedic doab → UP mahajanapadas → Sarnath / Kushinagar → Mathura Kushan → Bhitari Skandagupta → Kannauj Harsha.

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Early Vedic	Later Vedic	Pastoral Rigvedic Jana vs territorial janapadas / iron	ऋग्वैदिक / उत्तर वैदिक
Mahavira	Buddha	24th Jain Tirthankara vs Buddhism's founder	महावीर / बुद्ध
Chandragupta Maurya	Chandragupta I	Maurya founder vs Gupta dynasty starter	मौर्य / गुप्त

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Fa-Hien	Xuanzang	Gupta-age pilgrim vs Harsha-age pilgrim	फाह्यान / ह्वेनसांग
Vikrama Era 57 BCE	Saka Era 78 CE	Calendar eras often matched wrongly	विक्रम / शक
Kanishka	Samudragupta	Kushana emperor vs Gupta conqueror	कनिष्क / समुद्रगुप्त
Kalinga War	First Buddhist Council	Ashoka's war vs Ajatashatru-era council	कलिंग / प्रथम संगीति

A.0 Megaspine — memorise this first

Year	Event
c. 2600–1900 BCE	Mature Harappan urban phase
c. 1500–1000 BCE	Early Vedic (Rigvedic) age
c. 1000–600 BCE	Later Vedic age
c. 600 BCE	Sixteen Mahajanapadas; Magadha rises
c. 563 / 483 BCE	Birth / Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha (traditional)
326 BCE	Alexander invades; Battle of the Hydaspes
c. 321 BCE	Chandragupta Maurya founds the Mauryan Empire
c. 261 BCE	Ashoka's Kalinga War
185 BCE	Pushyamitra Shunga ends Mauryan rule
78 CE	Beginning of the Saka Era
c. 319–320 CE	Beginning of the Gupta Era; Chandragupta I
c. 375–415 CE	Chandragupta II Vikramaditya; Fa-Hien visits
606–647 CE	Harshavardhana of Kannauj; Xuanzang visits

A.1 Prehistoric India

Year	Event
Palaeolithic	Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic cultures; Soan Valley and Bhimbetka sequence in coaching maps
Mesolithic	Microlithic tools; hunting–gathering with early domestication at some sites; rock art continuity
Neolithic	Settled agriculture and pottery; Mehrgarh as the classic early farming settlement
Chalcolithic	Copper + stone cultures across the Deccan, Rajasthan and Gangetic fringe
Iron Age / NBPW	Spread of iron; Northern Black Polished Ware linked to second urbanisation and Magadha

A.2 Indus / Harappan Civilization

Year	Event
c. 3300–2600 BCE	Early Harappan / regionalisation phase; early Indus script signs appear
c. 2800 BCE	Harappa and Mohenjo-daro grow into major urban centres in coaching timelines
c. 2600–1900 BCE	Mature Harappan — planned cities, baked brick, drainage, seals, craft specialisation, long-distance trade
c. 1900–1300 BCE	Late Harappan / decline and localisation; Cemetery H and related cultures

Year	Event
Key sites	Harappa, Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira, Lothal, Kalibangan, Rakhigarhi, Banawali — learn site↔feature matches separately in Topic 2

A.3 Vedic Age

Year	Event
c. 1500–1000 BCE	Early Vedic / Rigvedic age; pastoral Jana polity; composition of the Rigveda
c. 1200–1000 BCE	Kuru polity emerges as an important Later Vedic political centre in many reconstructions
c. 1000–600 BCE	Later Vedic age; expansion into the Ganga valley; territorial janapadas; varna order hardens
c. 700–500 BCE	Composition and teaching of major Upanishads; end of the classical Vedic period in broad keys
c. 700 BCE	Kosala and other eastern kingdoms strengthen within the Northern Black Polished Ware world

A.4 Mahajanapadas, Jainism & Buddhism

Year	Event
c. 600 BCE	Sixteen Mahajanapadas listed in the Anguttara Nikaya; Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa and Avanti as the Big Four
c. 599 BCE	Traditional birth of Mahavira, 24th Tirthankara of Jainism
c. 563 BCE	Traditional birth of Siddhartha Gautama (the Buddha) at Lumbini
c. 544–492 BCE	Bimbisara of the Haryanka dynasty rules Magadha; contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira
c. 527 BCE	Traditional nirvana / moksha of Mahavira
c. 492–460 BCE	Ajatashatru rules Magadha; fortifies Rajagriha; conflicts with Vajji / Licchavi
c. 483 BCE	Traditional Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha at Kushinagar
c. 483 BCE	First Buddhist Council at Rajagriha under Ajatashatru
c. 383 BCE	Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali
c. 413–345 BCE	Shishunaga dynasty controls Magadha after the Haryankas
c. 345–321 BCE	Nanda dynasty under Mahapadma Nanda and Dhana Nanda — Magadha at peak before the Mauryas
c. 350 BCE	Panini of Gandhara composes the Ashtadhyayi — classical Sanskrit grammar

A.5 Alexander & the Mauryan Empire

Year	Event
327–326 BCE	Alexander invades the north-west; Ambhi of Taxila submits
326 BCE	Battle of the Hydaspes — Alexander defeats Porus
325–324 BCE	Alexander retreats from the Beas; Macedonian hold in the north-west weakens
c. 321 BCE	Chandragupta Maurya overthrows the Nandas with Chanakya's help; capital at Pataliputra
c. 305–303 BCE	Chandragupta's war and treaty with Seleucus Nicator — north-west territories for elephants; Megasthenes later at Pataliputra
c. 297–273 BCE	Bindusara succeeds Chandragupta; Deccan expansion continues
c. 273 / 268 BCE	Ashoka ascends (coaching keys use either year; reign conventionally to c. 232 BCE)
c. 261 BCE	Kalinga War; Ashoka turns to Dhamma after the slaughter

Year	Event
c. 260–250 BCE	Ashokan Major and Minor Rock Edicts and Pillar Edicts; Buddhist missions; Third Buddhist Council tradition at Pataliputra
c. 232 BCE	Death of Ashoka; later Mauryas weaken
c. 230 BCE	Simuka founds the Satavahana power in the Deccan as Mauryan control fades
185 BCE	Pushyamitra Shunga kills Brihadratha and founds the Shunga dynasty — end of Mauryan rule

A.6 Post-Mauryan to Kushanas

Year	Event
185–73 BCE	Shunga dynasty in the Gangetic heartland; Brahmanical patronage; conflict with Indo-Greeks
c. 73–28 BCE	Kanva dynasty briefly succeeds the Shungas
c. 180–165 BCE	Indo-Greek power in the north-west; Menander (Milinda) as the most famous Indo-Greek king
57 BCE	Beginning of the Vikrama Era (coaching calendar tag)
c. 1st cent. BCE – 3rd cent. CE	Satavahana Empire in the Deccan; conflict and exchange with the Shakas
30 BCE / 1st cent. CE	Early historic Tamilakam — Chera, Chola, Pandya; Sangam literature phase
78 CE	Beginning of the Saka Era
c. 1st–3rd cent. CE	Shaka Kshatrapas in western India; Kushana Empire from Central Asia into the plains
c. 78 / 127 CE	Kanishka's accession (date debated); Kushana zenith; Gandhara–Mathura art; Fourth Buddhist Council tradition
c. 100 CE	Charaka Samhita tradition — classical Ayurveda compilation associated with this era in coaching keys

A.7 Gupta Age

Year	Event
c. 240–280 CE	Sri Gupta and early Guptas as local Magadha rulers
c. 319–320 CE	Chandragupta I; beginning of the Gupta Era; marriage alliance with the Licchavis
c. 335–375 CE	Samudragupta's conquests; Allahabad / Prayaga Prashasti of Harishena; Vincent Smith's "Indian Napoleon" tag
c. 345 CE	Mayurasharma founds the Kadamba kingdom at Banavasi
c. 375–415 CE	Chandragupta II Vikramaditya (विक्रमादित्य); defeat of western Shakas; court of the Navaratnas; age of Kalidasa (कालिदास) in coaching keys
c. 399–414 CE	Fa-Hien (Faxian) travels in Gupta India
c. 415–455 CE	Kumaragupta I; title Mahendraditya; Nalanda's early growth under Gupta patronage
c. 455–467 CE	Skandagupta faces the Hunas
476 CE	Birth of Aryabhata — Aryabhatiya; place-value and astronomical work
c. 467–550 CE	Later Guptas weaken; Huna pressure; regional break-up
c. 528 CE	Yashodharman and allied rulers defeat Mihirakula's Hunas at the Battle of Sondani

Year	Event
c. 550 CE	Imperial Gupta power effectively ends

A.8 Harsha & late ancient South

Year	Event
c. 550–606 CE	Post-Gupta regional kingdoms; Rise of Pushyabhuti power at Thanesar
606 CE	Harshavardhana crowned; later rules from Kannauj
c. 630–644 CE	Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) travels in India; describes Harsha and Nalanda
c. 634–637 CE	Pulakeshin II of Badami Chalukyas checks Harsha on the Narmada
628 CE	Brahmagupta completes the Brahmasphutasiddhanta
647 CE	Death of Harsha; rapid fragmentation of north India — early medieval transition
Pallavas	Kanchipuram capital; Mahendravarman I and Narasimhavarman I; rock-cut to structural temples
Badami Chalukyas	Pulakeshin II's peak; conflict with Pallavas and Harsha
c. 753 CE	Dantidurga founds the Rashtrakuta kingdom of Manyakhet — counted with early medieval south

Practice Zone — Arrange / Chronology Drill

25 stems. Prefer full year order in the answer.

Common Traps

1. **Chandragupta Maurya = Chandragupta I** → different dynasties.
2. **Fa-Hien = Harsha** → Fa-Hien is Gupta-age; Xuanzang is Harsha-age.
3. **Alexander after Chandragupta** → Alexander **before** Mauryan foundation.
4. **Kanishka = Gupta** → Kushana, not Gupta.
5. **First Buddhist Council under Ashoka** → First is Rajagriha; Ashoka linked to the Third.
6. **Saka Era = 57 BCE → 78 CE**; Vikrama is **57 BCE**.
7. **Kalinga War = 185 BCE → c. 261 BCE**; 185 is Mauryan end.

Topic 1 — Stone Age (Prehistoric India)

Confused Pairs

A	B	Correct	Hindi
Paleolithic	Neolithic	Chipped handaxe vs polished/ground axe	पुरापाषाण / नवपाषाण
Microlith	Handaxe	Mesolithic composite blade vs Lower Paleolithic biface	सूक्ष्म पाषाण / हाथ कुल्हाड़ी
Bagor	Sarai Nahar Rai	Mesolithic domestication (RJ) vs Mesolithic burials (UP)	बागोर / सराय नाहर राय
Mehrgarh	Koldihwa	Wheat/barley (Balochistan) vs rice (UP Belan)	मेहरगढ़ / कोलडिहवा
Burzahom	Chirand	Kashmir pit dwellings vs Bihar bone tools	बुरज़होम / चिरांद
Rock shelter	Carved cave	Natural overhang (Bhimbetka) vs cut cave (Ajanta)	शैल आश्रय / कृत्रिम गुफा
Chalcolithic	Harappan	Rural copper+stone vs urban bronze/planned cities	ताम्रपाषाण / हड़प्पा
Hathnora fossil	Attirampakkam	<i>Homo erectus</i> skull vs old tools (no fossil)	हथनौरा / अतिरमपाक्कम
Wakankar	Sankalia	Bhimbetka discoverer vs Langhnaj/Deccan pioneer	वाकणकर / सांकलिया
OCP	Harappan ware	Doab ochre pottery (Chalcolithic) vs Indus urban pottery	गेरूआ मृद्भांड
Soanian	Acheulian	NW pebble/chopper (Soan–Siwalik) vs peninsular handaxe-cleaver	सोहन / ऐशूलियन
Baghor	Bagor	Upper Pal shrine, Son valley MP vs Meso domestication, Rajasthan	बाघोर / बागोर
Non-geometric microlith	Geometric microlith	Earlier Meso (backed blades) vs later Meso (lunate/triangle/trapeze)	अज्यामितीय / ज्यामितीय
Aceramic Neolithic	Ceramic Neolithic	Mehrgarh Period I (no pottery) vs later pottery levels	बिना मृद्भांड / मृद्भांड युक्त
Prehistoric	Proto-historic	No writing vs undeciphered script (e.g. Indus / Copper Age)	प्रागैतिहासिक / आद्यऐतिहासिक
Damdama triple burial	Sarai Nahar Rai four-skeleton grave	One triple grave at Damdama vs four skeletons in one grave at Sarai Nahar Rai	दमदमा / सराय नाहर राय
Lahuradewa	Mehrgarh	Early Ganga rice (Sant Kabir Nagar) vs NW wheat–barley village (Balochistan)	लहुरादेवा / मेहरगढ़

1.2 Stone Age

Period	Approx. (India)	Economy	Defining fact
Paleolithic	~2 mya – 10,000 BCE	Hunting and gathering	Chipped stone (core, flake, blade)
Mesolithic	~10,000 – 4000 BCE	Hunting, fishing; some sedentism	Microliths
Neolithic	~7000 – 1000 BCE	Food production	Ground or polished stone, pottery, villages

Period	Approx. (India)	Economy	Defining fact
Chalcolithic	~3000 – 1000 BCE	Farming villages plus first metal	Copper plus stone ; rural, not Harappan cities

Tool class	What it is	Typical period
Chopper / chopping	Pebble tool, one or both edges flaked	Lower Pal Soanian
Handaxe / cleaver	Bifacial core tool (Acheulian)	Lower Paleolithic

Tool class	What it is	Typical period
Flake	Struck from prepared core (Levallois)	Middle Paleolithic
Blade / burin / scraper	Long parallel-sided flake	Upper Paleolithic
Microlith	1–8 cm composite blade	Mesolithic
Celt / ground axe, quern	Polished/ground stone	Neolithic

1.3 Paleolithic Age

Sub-period	Approx.	Tools (booklet triad)
Lower	~2 mya – 100,000 BP	Handaxe, cleaver, chopper — Acheulian / Soanian cores
Middle	~100,000 – 35,000 BP	Points, borers, scrapers ; flake / Levallois
Upper	~35,000 – 10,000 BP	Burins with blades and scrapers; bone tools; ostrich-eggshell beads
Lower Pal tradition	Zone	Fact
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Sonian	Soan–Siwalik (Punjab/Pakistan)	Pebble chopper-chopping ; Yale–Cambridge team under H. De Terra (with Paterson), 1935
Acheulian (also called Madrasian in older books)	Peninsula + Narmada + Kortallayar	Handaxe-cleaver ; Foote at Pallavaram and Attirampakkam

1.5 Neolithic Age

Region	Crop / trait
Northwest (Mehrgarh)	Wheat, barley
Eastern UP / Belan	Rice (Koldihwa, Mahagara)
Ganga plain (Lahuradewa)	Early rice (lake-edge; not Belan)
South India	Millet s; ash-mound pastoral sites
Kashmir	Pit dwellings; fishing/hunting heavy (Burzahom, Gufkral)

1.11 Cave Paintings

Colour	Pigment	Typical use (Bhimbetka rule of thumb)
Red	Haematite / ochre	Animals
White	Limestone / kaolin	Human figures, dancers
Green	Chromium minerals	Less common
Black	Manganese / charcoal	Occasional

Common Traps — Facts

- Wakankar vs Sankalia vs Vatsa** → Bhimbetka = **Wakankar 1957–58**; Sankalia = Langhnaj/Navdatoli; Vatsa = **Harappan**.
- Bagor vs Sarai Nahar Rai vs Bori** → Bagor = **domestication (RJ)**; SNR = **burials (UP)**; Bori = Paleolithic distractor.

3. **Baghor = Bagor** → Baghor = **Upper Pal, Son valley MP**; Bagor = **Meso Rajasthan**.
4. **Mehrgarh = rice / in India / Harappan / no farming because aceramic** → Wheat-barley + cotton, **Balochistan, pre-urban**; aceramic = no **pottery**.
5. **Burzahom / Chirand / Koldihwa swap** → Kashmir **pits**; Bihar **bone**; Belan **rice**. Cattle pen = **Mahagara**, not pits.
6. **Polished axe = Paleolithic → Neolithic**. Handaxe = **Lower Paleolithic / Acheulian**.
7. **Soanian = Acheulian handaxe** → Soanian = **pebble chopper** (Siwalik); Acheulian = **handaxe-cleaver**.
8. **Microlith = Paleolithic / Chalcolithic → Mesolithic** composite blade.
9. **All Bhimbetka art is Paleolithic / found in 2003** → Art mostly Meso+; discovery **1957–58**; UNESCO **2003**. **Raisen, Vindhyan**, not Satpura/KA.
10. **Rock shelter = Ajanta / Lakhudiyar = Bhimbetka** → Shelter = **natural**; Ajanta = **carved**; Lakhudiyar = **Uttarakhand**.
11. **Chalcolithic = Harappan cities / Gungeria = dock** → Rural copper+stone; OCP = **doab**; Gungeria = **Copper Hoard, MP**.
12. **Hathnora = sapiens / found by Wakankar** → **Homo erectus, Sonakia 1982**. Attirampakkam = **tools**, Kortallayar TN.
13. **Inamgaon / Jorwe in Rajasthan** → **Maharashtra**. Ahar = Rajasthan. Navdatoli = **Narmada/Malwa**.
14. **Lahuradewa = Koldihwa / Belan** → Lahuradewa = **Sant Kabir Nagar**; Belan = Mirzapur–Prayagraj.
15. **Ash mounds = Gangetic / wild rice at SNR = cultivation** → Ash mounds = **South India**; SNR wild rice = Meso **gathering**.

Topic 2 — Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)

Current Affairs

- **2021:** Dholavira → UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- **2018:** Sanauli chariot burials (ASI).
- **2026:** Rakhigarhi skeletons to AnSI (Kolkata) and BSIP Lucknow for DNA / facial reconstruction; ASI 3-year excavation.
- **Budget 2026:** 15 archaeological sites as experiential destinations, including **Lothal** and **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी).

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Harappan	Indus Valley	Same culture; named after first site Harappa	हड़प्पा / सिंधु घाटी
Citadel	Lower town	Raised west platform vs larger east residential zone	दुर्ग / निम्न नगर
Alamgirpur	Rakhigarhi	Easternmost, UP vs largest in India, Haryana	आलमगीरपुर / राखीगढ़ी
Lothal	Dholavira	Dockyard vs reservoirs + signboard	लोथल / धोलावीरा
Mandi (UP)	Manda (J&K)	Muzaffarnagar vs Chenab, northernmost	मंडी / मांडा
IVC	Rigvedic	Urban vs pastoral	नगरीय / पशुपालक
OCP	Mature Harappan	Doab ochre pottery vs urban peak	गेरूआ मृद्भांड
Seal	Script	Steatite object vs unread signs on it	मुद्रा / लिपि
Proto-historic	Historic	Undeciphered Harappan script vs usable written history (~6th c. BCE)	आद्यऐतिहासिक / ऐतिहासिक
Cemetery R-37	Cemetery H	Mature Harappa coffin cemetery vs Late Harappan urn / fractional burial	आर-37 / सीमेट्री एच
Cow on seals	Unicorn / bull on seals	Cow absent vs common seal animals	गाय / एकशृंगी-वृषभ
Sohgaura	Chanhudaro	Mauryan copper-plate village (Gorakhpur) vs Harappan craft town (Sindh)	सोहगौरा / चन्हूदड़ो

AT A GLANCE

- Bronze Age Urban Civilization
- Mature Phase: 2600–1900 BCE
- Also called: Harappan / Sindhu–Saraswati Civilization
- First Urban Civilization of Indian Subcontinent

INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION (HARAPPAN CIVILIZATION)

★ ★ UPPCS REVISION SHEET ★ ★

EXAM WEIGHT

★ ★ ★ ★

- Site ↔ State mapping
- UP trio (Alamgirpur, Hulas, Mandi)
- Easternmost site
- Dockyard / Boats
- Excavators

DISCOVERY & EXCAVATIONS

- Charles Masson – 1826: first noticed Harappa ruins
- Cunningham – 1875: published a Harappa seal
- Daya Ram Sahni – 1921: Harappa
- R.D. Banerji – 1922: Mohenjo-daro
- J. Marshall – 1924: announced the discovery of a Civilization

CHRONOLOGY

Early Harappan 3300–2600 BCE	Mature Harappan 2600–1900 BCE	Late Harappan 1900–1300 BCE
Regional cultures (Kot Diji, Amri, Hakra, Soth) Pre-urban	Urbanization at its peak Planned cities Trade Craft Script	Ruralization Smaller settlements Decline of urban centers

KEY FEATURES



Bronze Age



URBAN
(2020 Q21)



Bricks
1:2:4



Script
Unread

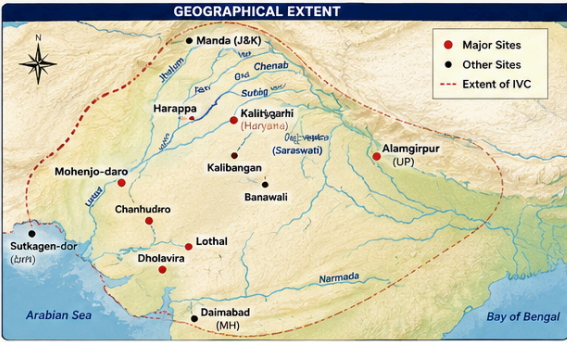


No Iron



No Coins

GEOGRAPHICAL EXTENT



The map shows the Indus River system flowing from the Himalayas into the Arabian Sea. Major sites are marked: Manda (J&K), Harappa, Kalitgarhi (Haryana), Mohenjo-daro, Kalibangan, Banawali, Chanhudaro, Lothal, Dholavira, Daimabad (MH), and Alamgirpur (UP). The extent of the IVC is indicated by a dashed red line. Major sites are marked with red dots, and other sites with black dots.

IMPORTANT POINTS

- Great Bath – Mohenjo-daro
- Dockyard – Lothal
- Boats – Mohenjo-daro & Lothal (2022 Q68)
- Dholavira – Water management, 10-sign board, 3 parts | UNESCO 2021
- Kalibangan – Ploughed field, Fire altars
- Chanhudaro – Bead industry, No citadel
- Unicorn – Most common seal
- Weights – 16 (binary system)
- Cotton – Earliest evidence

MAJOR SITES – AT A GLANCE

SITE	STATE/UT	SPECIAL FEATURE
Sutkagen-dor	Balochistan (Pak)	Westernmost Site
Manda	J&K	Northernmost Site (Chenab Valley)
Rakhigarhi	Haryana	Largest Site in India
Alamgirpur	Uttar Pradesh	Easternmost Site (Mereut)
Banawali	Haryana	Pre & Mature Harappan
Kalibangan	Rajasthan	Ploughed field, Fire altars
Mohenjo-daro	Sindh (Pak)	Great Bath, Granary
Harappa	Punjab (Pak)	First Site Excavated
Lothal	Gujarat	Dockyard, Beads, Trade
Dholavira	Gujarat	Water management, 10-sign board, 3 parts (UNESCO 2021)
Surkotada	Gujarat	Horse remains (controversial)
Daimabad	Maharashtra	Southernmost Site

TOWN PLANNING & CIVIC FEATURES

 Planned Cities Grid Pattern	 Citadel (West) Administrative area	 Lower Town (East) Residential area
 Drainage System Covered drains, household drains	 Great Bath (Mohenjo-daro)	 Granaries (Harappa, Mohenjo-daro)
	 Wells Public & Private	

HARAPPAN SCRIPT, SEALS & MEASUREMENTS

Script Unsolved Written right to left ~400–600 signs 	Seals Stattite seals Mostly square Unicorn most common 	Weights & Measures Standardized system Binary (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, ...) Chert weights mostly 
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CONFUSED PAIRS

PAIR	DIFFERENCE
Citadel ↔ Lower town	Raised West vs Larger East
Alamgirpur ↔ Rakhigarhi	Easternmost, UP vs Largest in India, Haryana
Lothal ↔ Dholavira	Dockyard vs Reservoirs + Signboard
Mandi (UP) ↔ Manda (J&K)	Bijnor vs Chenab, Northernmost
IVC ↔ Rigvedic	Urban vs Pastoral
OCF ↔ Mature Harappan	Doab ochre pottery vs Urban peak
Seal ↔ Script	Stattite object vs Unread signs

OTHER CULTURES & RELATED

Copper Hoard Culture	Ganga-Yamuna Doab
Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)	Upper Ganga Plain
Painted Grey Ware (PGW)	Later Vedic Period
Sanauli (UP)	Copper chariots (2018) – Later Harappan Phase?

IMPORTANT PYQ FACTS

- 2020 Q12 – Balu (Haryana), Manda (J&K), Padri (Gujarat), Hulas (UP)
- 2023 Q28 – Easternmost site: Alamgirpur (UP)
- 2025 Q67 – Rakhigarhi is in Hissar (Haryana), NOT UP
- 2022 Q68 – Boats found at Mohenjo-daro & Lothal
- 2020 Q21 – IVC is URBAN Civilization

SOURCES

NCERT – Themes in Indian History | RS Sharma | ASI | UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025

CURRENT AFFAIRS

- Dholavira UNESCO World Heritage Site – 2021
- Rakhigarhi 2026 – ASI DNA & facial reconstruction
- Budget 2026 – Lothal & Rakhigarhi among 15 experiential sites

QUICK MEMORY HOOK

"MERA BADLA DIL KHO GAYA"

M = Manda (N)	R = Rakhigarhi (Large)	L = Lothal (Dockyard)
D = Daimabad (S)	B = Balu/Banawali (Haryana)	D = Dholavira (10 Sign)
A = Alamgirpur (E)	K = Kalibangan (Rajasthan)	G = Great Bath (MD)

1. **Rakhigarhi in UP / eastern boundary → Hisar, Haryana; east = Alamgirpur.**
2. **Mandi = Manda → Mandi = Muzaffarnagar, UP; Manda = J&K, northernmost.**
3. **Lothal = Dholavira → Lothal = dockyard; Dholavira = water + signboard (UNESCO 2021).**
4. **Boat models at Dholavira → Mohenjo-daro + Lothal (2022).**
5. **Kalibangan / Lothal in UP → Rajasthan / Gujarat (2018).**
6. **IVC = pastoral → Urban; pastoral = Rigvedic.**
7. **Wheeler discovered IVC → Sahni 1921, Banerji 1922, Marshall 1924.**
8. **Great Bath at Harappa / Dholavira → Mohenjo-daro only.**
9. **Iron / coins / decoded Sanskrit script → all false.**
10. **Horse is definite → only Surkotada, and disputed.**
11. **Chanhudaro = citadel city → bead town, no citadel.**
12. **OCP = Mature Harappan grid → doab ochre pottery.**
13. **Sanauli = Great Bath city → Baghpat chariots, Late Harappan/OCP.**
14. **Balu = UP / Padri = Haryana → Balu = Haryana, Padri = Gujarat, Hulas = UP.**
15. **Daimabad in Gujarat → Maharashtra; bronzes ≠ Sanauli chariots.**

Topic 3 — Vedic Civilization

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Rigvedic	Later Vedic	Pastoral , Punjab, assemblies strong vs agrarian , doab, king strong	ऋग्वेदिक / उत्तर वैदिक
Sabha	Samiti	Elders/nobles (later exclusive) vs general tribal assembly that chooses the rajan	सभा / समिति
Sabha	Vidatha	Political/judicial elite vs oldest gathering — economic + ritual , women, fades first	सभा / विदथ
Bhagadugha	Sangrahitri	Collects king's share (bhaga) vs treasurer	भागदुघ / संग्रहीतृ
Bhagadugha	Akshavapa	Revenue vs dice / gambling officer	भागदुघ / अक्षवाप
Shukla Yajurveda	Krishna Yajurveda	Vajasaneyi (mantra & prose separate) vs Taittiriya / Kathaka / Maitrayani (mixed). Krishna here = Black Yajurveda , not the god Krishna	शुक्ल / कृष्ण यजुर्वेद
Indra	Agni	~ 250 hymns, war/rain vs ~ 200 hymns, fire / offering-carrier	इन्द्र / अग्नि
Indra (Early)	Prajapati (Later)	War-chief god of Rigveda vs creator / ritual supreme of Later Vedic	इन्द्र / प्रजापति
Vishnu (RV)	Vishnu (Later)	Minor in Rigveda vs rises with Rudra in Later Vedic / Upanishadic age	ऋग्वेद विष्णु / उत्तर वैदिक विष्णु
Samhita	Brahmana	Hymns/mantras vs prose ritual explanation	संहिता / ब्राह्मण
Aranyaka	Upanishad	Forest symbolic ritual vs Brahman–Atman philosophy	आरण्यक / उपनिषद्
Varna	Jati	Four-fold (Purusha Sukta; rigid later) vs birth-group (post-Vedic)	वर्ण / जाति
Gavishti	Bali	Cattle-raid / war vs tribute to the king	गविष्टि / बलि
Nishka	Coin	Gold ornament / value-unit vs coined money (absent)	निष्क / मुद्रा
Shruti	Smriti	Heard (Veda corpus) vs remembered (later dharma texts)	श्रुति / स्मृति
Vedanga	Upanishad	Six limbs (tools) vs Vedanta (end of Veda)	वेदांग / उपनिषद्
PGW	NBPW	Later Vedic grey painted doab ware vs mahajanapada black polished elite ware	चित्रित धूसर / उत्तरी काली
PGW	OCP	Iron-age painted grey vs pre-PGW ochre-wash doab rural	PGW / OCP
shyama ayas	ayas (Rigveda)	Later Vedic iron vs Early Vedic copper/bronze	श्याम आयस / आयस
Trayi	Atharvaveda	Rig–Yajur–Sama liturgical trio vs fourth Veda of charms / household	त्रयी / अथर्ववेद
Karma-kanda	Jnana-kanda	Samhita + Brahmana ritual vs Aranyaka + Upanishad philosophy	कर्मकांड / ज्ञानकांड
Aghanya	Horse sacrifice	Cow “not to be killed” vs Ashvamedha horse rite	अघन्या / अश्वमेध
Sindhu (most named)	Saraswati (most sacred)	Frequency in hymns vs <i>Naditama</i> piety	सिन्धु / सरस्वती

Books and Writers — Vedic Age

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Ashtadhyayi</i> (अष्टाध्यायी)	Panini (पाणिनि)	Vyakarana; Classical Sanskrit grammar
<i>Nirukta</i> (निरुक्त)	Yaska (यास्क)	Etymology Vedanga

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
Chhanda / metre tradition	Pingala	Metre Vedanga

3.4 Vedic Administration

Ratnin (jewel-officer)	Role
Purohita	Chief priest and royal adviser
Senani	Army commander
Gramani	Village head
Suta	Charioteer / court bard
Kshattri	Chamberlain-type officer
Bhagadugha	Revenue collector of the king's bhaga
Sangrahitri	Treasurer
Akshavapa	Dice / gambling officer
Takshan	Carpenter
Govikartana	Cowherd / cattle officer in lists
Palagala	Another ratnin name in Later Vedic lists

Rigvedic vs Later Vedic — Comparison Framework

Point	Rigvedic	Later Vedic
Territory	Sapta Sindhu (Punjab)	Ganga–Yamuna doab and beyond
Economy	Pastoral (cattle wealth)	Agrarian (iron plough, surplus)
Polity	elected rajan + strong Sabha–Samiti–Vidatha	hereditary raja ; weaker assemblies
Society	flexible occupation; women freer	rigid varna ; women lose ground
Religion	nature gods; Indra tops hymns	ritual kings' yajnas; Prajapati / Vishnu / Rudra rise
Archaeology	no cities; ayas = copper/bronze	PGW + iron (<i>shyama ayas</i>)

Vedic Religion and Ritual

Rigvedic gods and hymn counts

God	Approx. Rigvedic hymns	Role / fact
Indra	~250 (largest)	War god, rain-bringer, slayer of Vritra ; called Purandara (fort-breaker)
Agni	~200 (second)	Fire god; carries offerings to other gods
Soma	~120	Ritual drink-god; Mandala IX is the Soma book
Ashvins	~50+	Twin healer / dawn horsemen gods
Varuna	fewer (but high prestige)	Guardian of rita (cosmic / moral order)
Mitra (मित्र -)	paired with Varuna	Treaty / friendship; often Mitra–Varuna
Maruts	storm band with Indra	Wind / storm companions
Ushas	dawn hymns	Dawn goddess
Savitr	solar	Invoked in the Gayatri (RV III.62.10)

God	Approx. Rigvedic hymns	Role / fact
Surya / Pushan	solar group	Sun and path / cattle-path gods
Vishnu	few / minor	Three strides myth; not yet supreme
Rudra	few / minor	Fierce storm / healer; later rises as Shiva

3.11 Four Vedas

Veda	Core content	Priest	Upaveda	Main Samhita(s)	Key Brahmana(s)	Structure fact
Rigveda	Oldest; hymns (<i>rik</i>)	Hotri / Hota	Ayurveda (often also linked Atharva)	Rigveda Samhita	Aitareya , Kausitaki	1028 hymns; ~10552 verses (<i>richas</i>); 10 mandalas
Samaveda (सामवेद)	Melodies (<i>saman</i>) for Soma	Udgatri	Gandharvaveda	Samaveda Samhita (mostly from Rig)	Tandya / Panchavimsha, Jaiminiya	Chant-book for sacrifice
Yajurveda (यजुर्वेद)	Sacrificial formulas (<i>yajus</i>)	Adhvaryu	Dhanurveda	Shukla:Vajasaneyi (Madhyandina, Kanva; paper: Vajasanami). Krishna: Taittiriya, Kathaka, Maitrayani (+ Kapishthala)	Shatapatha (Shukla, 100 ch.); Taittiriya (Krishna)	Shukla = mantra & Brahmana apart ; Krishna = mixed
Atharvaveda	Spells, healing, household	Brahman (rite supervisor)	Arthashastra (अर्थशास्त्र)	Atharvaveda Samhita	Gopatha (only one)	20 books; newest of the four; early iron hints

3.12 Brahmanas

Brahmana	Veda
Aitareya, Kausitaki (Shankhayana)	Rigveda
Tandya / Panchavimsha, Jaiminiya	Samaveda
Shatapatha (largest, 100 chapters)	Shukla Yajurveda
Taittiriya	Krishna Yajurveda
Gopatha (only one)	Atharvaveda

3.15 Vedangas

Vedanga	Job	Fact
Shiksha	Phonetics	Pratishakhya texts
Kalpa	Ritual sutras	Shrauta (public), Grihya (domestic), Dharma (law), Sulba (altar geometry — Baudhayana, Apastamba)
Vyakarana	Grammar	Panini , <i>Ashtadhyayi</i> (~5th c. BCE, edge of / just after Vedic)
Nirukta	Etymology	Yaska
Chhanda	Metre	Pingala
Jyotisha	Ritual calendar / astronomy	Vedanga Jyotisha

3.17 Iron Age in India

Region	Iron Age marker	Period fact
Northwest / doab	PGW then NBPW	Later Vedic → mahajanapada
South / Deccan	Megaliths + black-and-red ware	Pre-Sangam bed
Chalcolithic overlap	Limited copper before iron	Mehrgarh, Jorwe, OCP zones

UP Focus

Fact	Detail
Later Vedic core	Ganga–Yamuna doab — western–central UP
Kuru	Delhi–Haryana–Meerut belt; Hastinapur tradition
Panchala	Rohilkhand–central doab (Ahichchhatra near Bareilly)
Kosala	Eastern UP (later Ayodhya / Shravasti world)
Kashi	Varanasi
Videha	North Bihar (Janaka) — east of UP, linked in Shatapatha
PGW sites	Hastinapur (Meerut), Atranjikhhera (Etah), Ahichchhatra , Noh (Rajasthan)
Rigvedic	Not a UP heartland — Punjab / Sapta Sindhu

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Rigvedic** = agrarian / urban → **Pastoral**; urban = IVC; agrarian = Later Vedic (2020).
2. **Bhagadugha** = gambling / forest / messenger → **Revenue**; gambling = **Akshavapa** (2023 C).
3. **Taittiriya / Maitrayani / Kathak** = **Shukla** → all **Krishna (Black)** Yajurveda; Shukla = **Vajasaneyi** (2018). **Krishna** ≠ deity Krishna.
4. **Sabha** = **Samiti** = **Vidatha** → elders vs tribe vs oldest ritual-share gathering.
5. **Vedic Sabha** = **Gram Sabha / Rajya Sabha** → zero link.
6. **Nishka** = coin → gold ornament.
7. **Purusha Sukta** = oldest hymn → Mandala **X**, late.
8. **Upanishad** = **Vedanga** → Shruti / Vedanta, not a limb.
9. **Iron plough in Rigveda** → **Later Vedic**; RV *ayas* = copper/bronze.
10. **Women's status same throughout** → falls in **Later Vedic**.
11. **Gayatri** = **Atharvaveda** → RV III.62.10.
12. **Aitareya Brahmana** = **Samaveda** → **Rigveda**; Shatapatha = **Shukla Yajurveda**.
13. **Vidatha still powerful in Later Vedic** → **first to fade**.
14. **Alamgirpur** = **Vedic Videha** → **Harappan** east end (Meerut belt).
15. **Sayana** = **Vedic rishi** → **14th century** commentator.
16. **PGW** = **Sangam south / NBPW** → PGW = **Later Vedic doab**; NBPW = mahajanapada cities (Topic 5).
17. **Megalithic** = **PGW** → megaliths = **south/Deccan** Iron Age; PGW = **northwest doab**.
18. **Iron in Rigveda** = **shyamaayas** → RV *ayas* = copper/bronze; iron = **Later Vedic**.
19. **Indra hymns unknown / Vishnu tops RV** → Indra ~**250**, Agni ~**200**, Soma ~**120**; Vishnu **minor** in Rigveda.
20. **Krishna Yajurveda** = **Krishna-bhakti text** → Black Yajurveda school (mixed mantra–prose).

Topic 4 — Religious Movements

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Shramana	Brahmana	Renouncer, often nastika vs Vedic priestly orthodoxy	श्रमण / ब्राह्मण
Nastika	Astika	Reject Veda (Buddha, Jina, Ajivika, Charvaka) vs accept Veda	नास्तिक / आस्तिक
Four Noble Truths	Eightfold Path	Diagnosis of dukkha vs the Magga prescription	चार आर्य सत्य / अष्टांग मार्ग
Hinayana	Mahayana	Arhat , Pali, self-liberation vs bodhisattva , Sanskrit	हीनयान / महायान
Mahayana	Vajrayana	Sutra / emptiness vs tantra , mantra, Tibet	महायान / वज्रयान
Sthaviravada	Mahasanghika	Vaishali elders vs great assembly split	स्थविर / महासंघ
Theravada	Sarvastivada	Pali south-Asian line vs Sanskrit north line (4th Council)	थेरवाद / सर्वस्तिवाद
Mahasanghika	Mahayana	Vaishali early split school vs later great vehicle	महासंघ / महायान
Vaibhashika	Sautrantika	Sarvastivada Abhidharma orthodox vs sutra-only	वैभाषिक / सौत्रान्तिक
Nagarjuna	Nagasena	Madhyamaka philosopher vs Milinda Panha monk	नागार्जुन / नागसेन
Vinaya	Sutta	Monk rules vs Buddha's discourses	विनय / सुत्त
Chaitya	Vihara	Prayer hall vs monastery	चैत्य / विहार
Barabar	Ajanta	Maurian, Ajivika gift vs later Buddhist painted caves	बराबर / अजंता
Digambara	Svetambara	Sky-clad; women no moksha as women vs white-clad; women can	दिगंबर / श्वेतांबर
Mahavira	Parshvanatha	24th, 5 vows, lion , Pavapuri vs 23rd, 4 vows, serpent	महावीर / पार्श्वनाथ
Pavapuri	Sammed Shikhar	Mahavira only vs 20 tirthankaras (not Vasupujya)	पावापुरी / सम्मेद शिखर
Charvaka	Ajivika	Materialist, pratyaksha-only vs fatalist niyati	चार्वाक / आजीविक
Shaivism	Vaishnavism	Shiva / linga vs Vishnu / avatars	शैव / वैष्णव
Bhagavatism	Vaishnavism	Early Vasudeva-Krishna cult vs later full Vishnu tradition	भागवत / वैष्णव
Anekantavada	Syadvada	Many-sided reality vs seven-fold predication ("syat")	अनेकान्तवाद / स्याद्वाद
Anatta	Jiva	Buddhism: no permanent soul vs Jainism: real soul	अनात्मा / जीव
Pataliputra (Jain)	Vallabhi	Early Magadhan compilation / Sthulabhadra vs final Svetambara canon	पाटलिपुत्र / वल्लभी

Books and Writers — Religious Movements

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Milinda Panha</i>	Menander (Milinda) and Nagasena	Indo-Greek Buddhist dialogue
<i>Buddhacharita</i> (बुद्धचरित)	Ashvaghosha (अश्वघोष)	Sanskrit Buddha-life; Kanishka age
<i>Saundarananda</i> (सौंदरानंद)	Ashvaghosha	Same court circle
<i>Madhyamaka Karika</i>	Nagarjuna	Madhyamaka / sunyata
<i>Visuddhimagga</i>	Buddhaghosa	Theravada manual
<i>Mahavibhasha</i>	Fourth Council circle (Vasumitra ; Ashvaghosha age)	Sarvastivada; Kashmir / Kanishka
<i>Tattvartha Sutra</i>	Umasvati	Jain; accepted by Digambara and Svetambara

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Kalpasutra</i>	Bhadrabahu	Tirthankara lives; Paryushana reading
<i>Parishishtaparvan</i>	Hemachandra	Later Jain narrative

4.2 Buddha

Event	Place	Age / fact	Art symbol
Birth	Lumbini (Nepal)	Ashokan Rummindei pillar marks the site	Lotus and bull
Mahabhinishkramana	Kapilavastu departure	Age 29 ; horse Kanthaka , charioteer Channa	Horse
Enlightenment	Bodh Gaya (Bihar)	~35; under the Bodhi (peepul) tree; Uruvela	Bodhi / peepal tree
First sermon	Sarnath / Isipatana (UP)	Deer Park; <i>Dhammacakkappavattana</i>	Wheel (often with deer)
Mahaparinirvana	Kushinagar (UP)	80; Malla republic; between sala trees	Stupa

4.3 Four Noble Truths

#	Pali name	Meaning	Key fact
1	Dukkha	Suffering / unsatisfactoriness	Does not mean "life is only pain"
2	Samudaya	Cause of suffering	Tanha / trishna (craving), fed by avidya (ignorance)
3	Nirodha	Cessation of suffering	Craving can stop; that stop is nirvana
4	Magga	Path to cessation	Names the Eightfold Path as the cure

4.4 Eightfold Path

Group	Path factor	Sanskrit / Pali fact	What it means
Prajna (wisdom)	Right View	<i>samyag-drishṭi</i>	See the Four Noble Truths correctly
Prajna (wisdom)	Right Resolve	<i>samyak-saṅkalpa</i>	Right intention and renunciation
Sila (conduct)	Right Speech	<i>samyag-vac</i>	No lying, abuse, or idle harm
Sila (conduct)	Right Action	<i>samyak-karmanta</i>	Moral bodily conduct
Sila (conduct)	Right Livelihood	<i>samyag-ājīva</i>	Earn without harm
Samadhi (समाधि) (concentration)	Right Effort	<i>samyag-vyayama</i>	Train the mind and restrain unwholesome states
Samadhi (concentration)	Right Mindfulness	<i>samyak-smṛiti</i>	Constant awareness
Samadhi (concentration)	Right Concentration	<i>samyak-samadhi</i>	Meditative absorption

4.5 Buddhist Philosophy

Three marks and five skandhas

Mark / bundle	Meaning
Anicca	All conditioned things are impermanent
Dukkha	Unsatisfactoriness follows from impermanence
Anatta	There is no permanent self — split from Jain jiva and Upanishadic atman
Skandha	Sanskrit

Mark / bundle	Meaning
-----	-----
Form	Rupa
Feeling	Vedana
Perception	Samjna
Formations	Samskara
Consciousness	Vijnana

Dependent arising (Pratityasamutpada)

#	Nidana	Meaning
1	Avidya	Ignorance
2	Samskara	Volitional formations
3	Vijnana	Consciousness
4	Namarupa	Name and form
5	Sadayatana	Six sense bases
6	Sparsa	Contact
7	Vedana	Feeling
8	Trishna	Craving
9	Upadana	Clinging
10	Bhava (भाव)	Becoming
11	Jati (जाति)	Birth
12	Jara-marana	Old age and death

4.6 Buddhist Councils

Place order (highest-yield spine)

#	Place	Patron / ruler	President	Main outcome
1st (~483 BCE)	Rajagriha (Sattapanni / Saptaparni cave)	Ajatashatru (अजातशत्रु) (Magadha)	Mahakassapa	Upali recited Vinaya ; Ananda recited Suttas
2nd (~383 BCE)	Vaishali	Kalashoka	Sabakami / Sabbakami	Ten-point Vinaya dispute; split into Sthaviravada (elders) and Mahasanghika (great assembly)
3rd (c. 250 / 247 BCE)	Pataliputra	Ashoka (अशोक)	Moggaliputta Tissa	Vibhajjavada line wins; Abhidhamma and <i>Kathavatthu</i> ; missions to Sri Lanka (Mahinda , Sanghamitta)
4th (north-Indian list)	Kundalvana , Kashmir	Kanishka (कनिष्क)	Vasumitra (+ Ashvaghosha as deputy)	Sarvastivada school; Sanskrit turn; <i>Mahavibhasha</i> ; Mahayana gains Kushan patronage; Buddha elevated as deity in Mahayana framing

4.7 Buddhist Texts

Text	Fact
Milinda Panha	Dialogue of Indo-Greek Menander (Milinda) and monk Nagasena

Text	Fact
<i>Jataka</i>	547 stories of Buddha's previous births; in Khuddaka Nikaya
<i>Dhammapada</i>	Verse ethics; in Khuddaka Nikaya
<i>Buddhacharita</i>	Sanskrit Buddha-life by Ashvaghosha (Kanishka age); also wrote <i>Saundarananda</i>
<i>Mahavastu, Lalitavistara, Divyavadana</i>	Narrative Sanskrit Buddha lives
<i>Prajnaparamita, Lotus Sutra, Lankavatara</i>	Key Mahayana sutras
<i>Dipavamsa, Mahavamsa</i>	Sri Lankan chronicles
<i>Visuddhimagga</i>	Buddhaghosa's Theravada manual

4.8 Tripitaka

Pitaka	Content	Traditional reciter	Key fact
Vinaya	Monastic rules — Suttavibhanga, Khandhaka, Parivara	Upali	Sangha law
Sutta	Buddha's discourses — five nikayas (Digha, Majjhima, Samyutta, Anguttara, Khuddaka)	Ananda	Dhammapada and Jataka (547 stories) in Khuddaka
Abhidhamma	Scholastic analysis and lists	—	Tied to Third Council in Theravada memory; seven books include Yamaka , <i>Patthana</i> , <i>Kathavatthu</i> , <i>Puggalapannatti</i> , <i>Dhatukatha</i> , <i>Vibhanga</i> , <i>Dhammasangani</i>

4.9 Hinayana

Main early schools you must know

School	Origin / link	Doctrine or practice	Region / canon
Sthaviravada	Elders' side at Vaishali (2nd Council)	Orthodox Vinaya; parent line of later Hinayana schools	Ancestor school — not identical with Theravada
Mahasanghika	Liberal side at Vaishali	More relaxed monastic rules; some branches stressed the Buddha's supramundane nature	Influenced later Mahayana thought; not itself Mahayana
Theravada	Vibhajjavada line that wins at the 3rd Council (Ashoka)	Doctrine of analysis; arhat ideal; strict Vinaya	Pali Tripitaka; Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Cambodia, Laos
Sarvastivada	Branched from the Sthaviravada line; dominant in the north	Sarvam asti — dharmas exist in past, present, and future	Kashmir, Gandhara, Central Asia; Sanskrit ; 4th Council at Kundalvana
Vaibhashika	Subschool of Sarvastivada	Defends orthodox Abhidharma through the Mahavibhasha	Realist reading of "all exists"
Sautrantika	Subschool of Sarvastivada	Accepts sutras as supreme authority; rejects Vaibhashika Abhidharma orthodoxy	Sutra-only emphasis — paired trap with Vaibhashika

4.10 Mahayana

How Mahayana differs from Hinayana

Point	Hinayana / early schools	Mahayana
Ideal	Arhat — personal liberation	Bodhisattva — liberation for all beings

Point	Hinayana / early schools	Mahayana
Buddha	Great teacher	Compassionate saviour / celestial Buddha
Canon	Pali Tripitaka	Sanskrit Mahayana sutras added
Art	Early phase often aniconic	Human Buddha and bodhisattva images common
Living line today	Theravada in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia	East Asia, Nepal, Tibetan world

Bodhisattvas — full list

Bodhisattva	Also called	Virtue / role	Attribute or trap
Avalokiteshvara	Padmapani , Lokeshvara	Compassion ; hears the cries of all beings	Lotus; central in <i>Lotus Sutra</i> ; Ajanta Padmapani painting
Manjushri	—	Wisdom	Flaming sword and Prajnaparamita book
Vajrapani	—	Power / protection	Vajra (thunderbolt); attendant-protector of the Buddha
Maitreya	Ajita	Future Buddha	Only bodhisattva widely remembered in both early and Mahayana traditions
Tara	—	Female saviour	Compassion goddess linked to Avalokiteshvara tradition
Samantabhadra	—	Universal virtue / practice	Often paired with Manjushri in art
Kshitigarbha	—	Earth-store bodhisattva	Saves beings in hell realms
Akasagarbha	—	“Womb of space”	Space / void symbolism

Mahayana philosophy schools

School	Teacher	Key text / idea	Key fact
Madhyamaka	Nagarjuna	<i>Madhyamaka Karika</i> ; sunyata (emptiness)	Middle way between eternalism and nihilism
Yogacara / Vijnanavada	Asanga and Vasubandhu	Mind-only / consciousness-only	Not Early Nikaya teaching

4.11 Vajrayana

Three vehicles — summary

Vehicle	When	Goal	Method / canon	Living region or school
Hinayana	Early schools after Buddha	Arhat	Pali Tripitaka; strict Vinaya	Theravada in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia
Mahayana	From ~1st century CE	Bodhisattva	Sanskrit Mahayana sutras; philosophy schools	East Asia, Nepal, later eastern India
Vajrayana	From ~7th–8th century CE	Bodhisattva through tantra	Mantra, mandala, guru initiation	Tibet, Bhutan, parts of eastern India

4.12 Cave Architecture

Site	Type	Meaning
Barabar–Nagarjuni (Bihar)	Earliest rock-cut caves	Mauryan polish; Lomas Rishi (लोमश ऋषि) facade; gifted to Ajivikas
Bhaja, Karle, Bedsa, Kondane	Western Hinayana chaityas	Karle (कार्ले) = largest chaitya hall

Site	Type	Meaning
Ajanta (Maharashtra)	30 caves; famous paintings	Phase I = Hinayana/aniconic; Phase II = Mahayana (Padmapani)
Ellora (एलोरा)	Multi-religion hill	Buddhist 1–12, Hindu 13–29, Jain 30–34; Cave 16 Kailasa = Shaiva
Kanheri (कन्हेरी) (Mumbai)	Late western Buddhist	Eleven-headed Avalokiteshvara image; Sanjay Gandhi National Park
Ghantasala	Andhra stupa	Aryaka-pillars on platform — named site
Dhanyakataka (Dharanikota, Andhra)	Mahasanghika centre	Later Satavahana capital tradition

Stupa parts (vocabulary)

Part	What it is
Anda	Hemispherical dome
Harmika	Square railing on top of the dome
Chhatra	Umbrella-like finial
Pradakshina path	Circumambulation walkway; worship is clockwise
Ayaka platform	Cardinal platform with ayaka / aryaka-pillars — southern Andhra feature

4.13 Ashokan Patronage

Key Rock Edicts for Dhamma

Edict	What it says (key fact)
RE V	Creates Dhamma-mahamatras — 13 years after coronation (papers say “14th year”; treat as correct). These officers worked among all religions , cared for the poor, the aged, and prisoners.
RE XII	Religious tolerance — “One should honour others’ faiths. Praising one’s own and condemning others harms one’s own religion.”
RE XIII	Kalinga remorse — 1 lakh killed, 1.5 lakh deported. Ashoka’s turn to Dhamma-vijaya. Names five Hellenistic kings (Antiochus II, Ptolemy II, Antigonus, Magas, Alexander of Epirus).

Rahulovada trap

- The **Bhabru / Bairat edict** lists **seven Buddhist texts** Ashoka recommended for study by monks, nuns, and laity.
- One of those seven texts is the **Laghulovada** (Rahulovada-sutta from Majjhima Nikaya) — a sermon the Buddha gave to his son Rahula about **falsehood**.
- The Rahulovada is a text Ashoka **valued**, but it is **not** the source or definition of his Dhamma. His Dhamma is his **own edict-ethic**.
- stem: “Ashoka’s Dhamma is taken from the Rahulovada-sutta” → **False**.

4.14 Jainism

Jiva and Ajiva (soul vs non-soul)

Category	What it covers
Jiva (soul)	Every living being has a real, eternal soul. A liberated soul is called a siddha . This is the opposite of Buddhist anatta (no-soul).

Category	What it covers
Ajiva (non-soul)	Five types: pudgala (matter), dharma (medium of motion), adharma (medium of rest), akasha (space), kala (time).

Five types of knowledge (Jnana)

#	Jnana	Meaning
1	Mati	Sensory knowledge (ordinary perception)
2	Shruta	Scriptural / verbal knowledge
3	Avadhi	Clairvoyance (remote perception)
4	Manahpariyaya	Telepathy (reading others' minds)
5	Kevala	Omniscience — full, unlimited knowledge. A tirthankara attains this.

Five Kalyanakas (auspicious events of a tirthankara)

#	Kalyanaka	Event
1	Chyavana	Descent of the soul into the mother's womb
2	Janma	Birth
3	Diksha	Renunciation (becoming a monk)
4	Kevala	Attaining omniscience
5	Nirvana	Final liberation / death of the body

Three Jewels (Triratna) of Jainism

Jewel	Meaning
Samyak Darshana	Right faith / correct perception
Samyak Jnana	Right knowledge
Samyak Charitra	Right conduct

Jain philosophy — Anekantavada, Syadvada, Nayavada

Doctrine	Meaning	Key fact
Anekantavada	Reality is many-sided — no single statement captures the whole truth.	"Non-absolutism" or "many-sidedness of reality."
Syadvada	Seven-fold conditional predication ("syat" = in some respect). A way to speak about many-sided reality in 7 <i>bhanga</i> s.	Also called Saptabhangi .
Nayavada	Doctrine of standpoints — every judgment comes from a partial viewpoint (<i>naya</i>).	Perspective-based analysis.

#	Mode	Meaning
1	<i>Syad asti</i>	In some respect, it is
2	<i>Syad nasti</i>	In some respect, it is not
3	<i>Syad asti-nasti</i>	In some respect, it is and is not
4	<i>Syad avaktavya</i>	In some respect, it is indescribable
5–7	Combinations	Mix existence, non-existence, and indescribability

4.15 Tirthankaras

#	Tirthankara	Key fact
1	Rishabhanatha / Adinatha	Born Ayodhya (UP); nirvana Ashtapad ; symbol bull
—	Bahubali (son of Rishabha)	Gomateshwara at Shravanabelagola (981 CE); not one of the 24
22	Neminatha	Krishna's cousin; symbol conch ; nirvana Girnar
23	Parshvanatha	Symbol serpent ; nirvana Sammed Shikhar
24	Mahavira	Symbol lion ; nirvana Pavapuri

4.16 Tirthankaras and their Symbols

#	Tirthankara	Symbol
1	Rishabhanatha / Adinatha	Bull
2	Ajitanatha	Elephant
3	Sambhavanatha	Horse
4	Abhinandanatha	Monkey
5	Sumatinatha	Curlew / heron
6	Padmaprabha	Lotus
7	Suparshvanatha	Swastika
8	Chandraprabha	Crescent moon
9	Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha	Crocodile / makara
10	Shitalanatha	Shrivatsa
11	Shreyansanatha	Rhinoceros
12	Vasupujya	Buffalo
13	Vimalanatha	Boar
14	Anantanatha	Falcon / hawk (some lists: bear)
15	Dharmanatha	Vajra
16	Shantinatha	Deer
17	Kunthunatha	Goat
18	Aranatha	Fish / nandyavarta
19	Mallinatha	Kalasha
20	Munisuvrata	Tortoise
21	Naminatha	Blue lotus
22	Neminatha	Conch
23	Parshvanatha	Serpent
24	Mahavira	Lion

4.17 Nirvana Sites of Tirthankaras

Full list — all 24 nirvana sites

#	Tirthankara	Nirvana site	State / note
1	Rishabhanatha	Ashtapad (Mount Kailash)	Separate site
2	Ajitanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
3	Sambhavanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
4	Abhinandanananatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
5	Sumatinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
6	Padmaprabha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
7	Suparshvanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
8	Chandraprabha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
9	Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
10	Shitalanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
11	Shreyansanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
12	Vasupujya	Champapuri	Bihar (Bhagalpur belt) — 2021 UPPCS trap
13	Vimalanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
14	Anantanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
15	Dharmanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
16	Shantinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
17	Kunthunatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
18	Aranatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
19	Mallinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
20	Munisuvrata	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
21	Naminatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
22	Neminatha	Urjayanta / Girnar	Gujarat — separate site
23	Parshvanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand (one of the 20)
24	Mahavira	Pavapuri	Bihar — separate site

High-yield facts

Tirthankara	Nirvana site
Vasupujya (#12)	Champapuri (Bhagalpur, Bihar)
Parshvanatha (#23)	Sammed Shikhar (Jharkhand)
Mahavira (#24)	Pavapuri (Bihar)
Neminatha (#22)	Girnar / Urjayanta (Gujarat)
Rishabhanatha (#1)	Ashtapad (Kailash)

4.18 Parshvanatha

Fact	Parshvanatha (23rd)	Mahavira (24th)
Vows	Four (chaturyama): ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha	Five — added brahmacharya (ब्रह्मचर्य)

Fact	Parshvanatha (23rd)	Mahavira (24th)
Symbol	Serpent	Lion
Nirvana	Sammed Shikhar	Pavapuri
Birth (tradition)	Varanasi (UP)	Kundagrama (Vaishali belt)

4.19 Mahavira

Timeline (traditional chronology)

When (~BCE)	Age	Event
c. 599	0	Birth at Kundagrama (Vaishali / Vajji belt)
c. 569	30	Renunciation — left household life (Svetambara tradition)
c. 569–557	30–42	12 years of tapas (austerity)
c. 557	42	Kevala jnana (omniscience) at Jrimbhikagrama
c. 557	42	First sermon at Vipulachala (Rajgir)
c. 557–527	42–72	30 years of preaching
c. 527	72	Nirvana at Pavapuri (Magadha, Bihar)

Life facts

Fact	Detail
Parents	Father Siddhartha ; mother Trishala (Licchavi link)
Wife (Svetambara)	Yashoda ; daughter Priyadarshana
Marriage (Digambara)	Tradition says he never married
Chief disciple	Indrabhuti Gautama (of 11 ganadharas)
Symbol	Lion
Vows	Five — added brahmacharya to Parshva’s four
Pali name	Nigantha Nataputta
Early companion	Makkhali Gosala → later Ajivika teacher
Nirvana	Pavapuri , Bihar

4.20 Five Great Vows

#	Vow (Sanskrit)	Meaning	Monk (mahavrata)	Layperson (anuvrata)
1	Ahimsa	Non-violence in thought, word, and deed	Strict — no harm to any being	Avoid deliberate injury
2	Satya	Truthfulness	No false speech	Avoid harmful lies
3	Asteya	Non-stealing	No taking what is not given	No theft
4	Brahmacharya	Chastity / celibacy	Complete celibacy	Marital fidelity
5	Aparigraha	Non-possession	No property; sky-clad Digambaras take this furthest	Limit possessions

4.21 Digambara

Point	Digambara	Svetambara
Dress	Sky-clad (nude monks)	White-clad
Women’s moksha	Must be reborn as men (classic view)	Women can attain moksha
Canon	Shatkhandagama, Kasayapahuda	12 Angas (11 survive; Drishtivada lost)
Mallinatha	Male	Female
Geography	South — Shravanabelagola , Karnataka	North — Vallabhi final redaction

4.22 Svetambara

Jain councils and canon

#	Place	Leader	When (approx.)	Outcome
1st	Pataliputra (Bihar)	Sthulabhadra	~300 BCE	12 Angas arranged in Ardhamagadhi . Drishtivada (12th Anga) later lost .
2nd (two venues at once)	Mathura (UP) and Vallabhi (Gujarat)	Skandila (Mathura); Nagarjuna (Vallabhi I)	~4th c. CE	Oral texts gathered again after famine; Mathura is the UP venue.
3rd (final)	Vallabhi (Maitraka Gujarat)	Devardhigani Kshamashramana	~453–512 CE	Svetambara Agamas written down; 11 Angas + Upangas .

4.23 Shramana Tradition

Six rival teachers (*Samaññaphala Sutta*)

Teacher	Doctrine	One-line fact
Purana Kassapa	Akriya	Deeds have no moral fruit
Makkhali Gosala	Niyati (Ajivika)	Fate fixes all; effort cannot rewrite destiny
Ajita Kesakambalin	Uccheda materialism	Body is elements; death is the end
Pakudha Kaccayana	Seven eternal elements	No real moral agency
Nigantha Nataputta	Jain path	This is Mahavira — ahimsa and soul
Sanjaya Belatthiputta	Scepticism	The “eel-wiggler” — refused definite answers on soul and rebirth

4.24 Ajivika Sect

Fact	Detail
Founder-teacher	Makkhali Gosala — wandered with Mahavira, then broke away
Core doctrine	Niyati (fate) runs the universe; effort cannot rewrite destiny
Practice	Still practised hard asceticism despite fatalism
Patronage	Bindusara (बिन्दुसार) favoured Ajivikas; Ashoka gifted Barabar caves to them
Fate	Sect dies out after the Mauryas ; known mainly from Buddhist and Jain polemics
Sites	Barabar caves (Ajivika) vs Ajanta (Buddhist paintings)

4.25 Charvaka (Lokayata)

Fact	Charvaka position
Pramana	Pratyaksha (perception) is the sole valid means of knowledge
God / soul	No creator God, no soul, no afterlife
Karma / yajna	No karma, no rebirth, no Vedic yajna fruit
Ethics	This-world pleasure; "go loot" is polemic , not the doctrine
Founder-name	Brihaspati (traditional)
Sources	Original canon lost ; recovered from opponents like Madhava's <i>Sarvadarshanasangraha</i>
Related name	Charaka Samhita (चरक संहिता) = Ayurveda; Brihaspati = Lokayata founder-name

4.27 Heterodox Schools

School	Reject Veda?	Soul / karma?	One-line
Buddhism	Yes	No permanent soul; karma yes	Middle Path
Jainism	Yes	Soul yes; karma as matter	Ahimsa, 24 jinas
Ajivika	Yes	Fate over karma-ethic	Niyati
Charvaka	Yes	Neither	Perception-only

4.28 Hinduism

Six orthodox (astika) schools

School	Focus
Nyaya (न्याय)	Logic and epistemology
Vaisheshika (वैशेषिक)	Atomism and categories
Samkhya (सांख्य)	Dualism: purusha and prakriti
Yoga (योग)	Discipline of mind and body (Patanjali)
Mimamsa (मीमांसा)	Vedic ritual interpretation
Vedanta (वेदांत)	Upanishadic philosophy (Advaita, Vishishtadvaita, Dvaita)

4.29 Shaivism

Jyotirlinga	Place
Somnath	Gujarat
Mallikarjuna / Srisailem	Andhra Pradesh
Mahakaleshwar	Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh
Omkareshwar	Madhya Pradesh
Kedarnath	Uttarakhand
Bhimashankar	Maharashtra
Kashi Vishwanath	Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)
Trimbakeshwar	Maharashtra

Jyotirlinga	Place
Vaidyanath / Baidyanath	Jharkhand (Deoghar claim)
Nageshwar	Gujarat
Rameshwaram	Tamil Nadu
Grishneshwar	Maharashtra

4.30 Vaishnavism

Avatar	Note
Matsya	Fish
Kurma	Tortoise
Varaha	Boar
Narasimha	Man-lion
Vamana	Dwarf
Parashurama	Axe-Rama
Rama	Ayodhya
Krishna	Mathura
Buddha or Balarama	Lists vary
Kalki	Future

UP Focus

Fact	Place
First sermon	Sarnath , Varanasi (Deer Park)
Mahaparinirvana	Kushinagar
Jetavana / Kosala	Shravasti
Descent from heaven (tradition)	Sankisa (Farrukhabad)
Kosambi monastery	Kaushambi
Parshvanatha birth tradition	Varanasi
Rishabhanatha birth tradition	Ayodhya
Jain images / stupa	Mathura Kankali Tila
Bhagavata / Krishna	Mathura–Vrindavan
Rama	Ayodhya
Jyotirlinga	Kashi Vishwanath
Shakta	Vindhyachal (Mirzapur)

Common Traps — Facts

1. **First council at Vaishali** → **Rajagriha**; Vaishali = 2nd (2025).
2. **Kundalvana before Pataliputra** → Kundalvana is **4th**.
3. **Nagarjuna wrote Milinda Panha** → **Nagasena** (2023).
4. **Rahulovada = Ashoka's Dhamma definition** → **false** (2024).

5. **Barabar = Buddhist Ajanta** → Barabar = **Ajivika**, Mauryan.
6. **Aryaka pillars at Bodh Gaya** → **Ghantasala** (2022).
7. **Vasupujya = Sammed Shikhar** → **Champapuri** (2021).
8. **Mahavira symbol = serpent** → **lion**; serpent = **Parshva**.
9. **All 24 nirvana at Sammed Shikhar** → only **20**; four exceptions.
10. **Chaitya = vihara** → hall vs monastery.
11. **Buddhism accepts atman** → **anatta**.
12. **Charvaka = Ajivika** → perception-only vs **niyati**.
13. **Charaka Samhita = Lokayata** → Ayurveda.
14. **Ellora 16 = Buddhist** → **Shaiva** Kailasa.
15. **Lumbini in UP** → **Nepal**; UP = Sarnath + Kushinagar (+ Shravasti, Sankisa, Kaushambi).
16. **Mahavira founded Jainism / was 1st tirthankara** → 24th; first = **Rishabha**.
17. **Vallabhi = 2nd Buddhist council** → Jain **Svetambara** canon; Buddhist 2nd = **Vaishali**.
18. **Digambara: Mahavira married Yashoda** → that is **Svetambara**; Digambara: never married.
19. **Anekantavada = Buddhist Middle Path** → Jain many-sided real; Middle Path = Buddha.
20. **Tattvartha Sutra = Digambara-only** → **both** sects (Umasvati).
21. **Hinayana = Theravada only** → Theravada is the **only surviving** Hinayana school; Sarvastivada and Mahasanghika were separate early lines.
22. **Mahasanghika = Mahayana** → Vaishali **early split** vs later **great vehicle**.
23. **Vaibhashika / Sautrantika = separate vehicles** → both are **Sarvastivada subschools**.
24. **Vajrayana at Buddha's time** → **7th–8th century CE** tantric offshoot of Mahayana.
25. **All bodhisattvas in one comma line** → learn **Avalokiteshvara, Manjushri, Vajrapani, Maitreya, Tara** as separate facts.

Topic 5 — Sixth Century BCE

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Janapada	Mahajanapada	Clan territory vs the 16 large states	जनपद / महाजनपद
Monarchy	Gana-sangha	Hereditary king vs oligarchic clan-council	राजतंत्र / गणसंघ
Rajagriha	Pataliputra	Early Magadha capital vs later Ganga–Son capital	राजगृह / पाटलिपुत्र
Ajatashatru (Patali)	Udayin (capital)	Fortifies / founds Pataligrama seed vs first makes Pataliputra the capital	अजातशत्रु / उदयन
Udayin (Magadha)	Udayana (Vatsa)	Haryanka capital-shifter vs Vatsa king of Kaushambi	उदयन मगध / उदयन वत्स
Matsya	Surasena	Viratnagar (Rajasthan) vs Mathura	मत्स्य / शूरसेन
Kashi	Kosala	Varanasi vs Ayodhya / Shravasti	काशी / कोसल
Vatsa	Panchala	Kaushambi vs Ahichchhatra / Kampilya	वत्स / पांचाल
Magadha	Vajji	Magadhan kingdom (Bihar) vs Licchavi republic (Vaishali)	मगध / वज्जि
Bimbisara	Ajatashatru	Alliances + Anga vs parricide + Vajji war	बिम्बिसार / अजातशत्रु
Haryanka	Shishunaga	Bimbisara line vs minister who took Avanti	हर्यक / शिशुनाग
Mahapadma	Dhana Nanda	Founder / ekarat vs last Nanda, Alexander age	महापद्म / धननन्द
Potana	Pratishthana	Asmaka capital in 2020 paper vs later Satavahana Paithan	पोतन / प्रतिष्ठान
PGW	NBPW	Later Vedic doab grey ware vs mahajanapada / early historic deluxe black ware	चित्रित धूसर / उत्तरी काली
Girivraja	Pataliputra	Rajgir five-hill fort vs Ganga–Son city	गिरिव्रज / पाटलिपुत्र
Kushinagar	Pava	Both Malla vs Jain Pavapuri (Mahavira) in Magadha	कुशीनगर / पावा
Champa	Varanasi	Anga river-port vs Kashi	चम्पा / वाराणसी
Buddha-age ganas	Yaudheya	Shakya / Licchavi / Malla list vs later plains gana (not “earlier republic” stem)	गण / यौधेय
Avantika	Taxila	Ancient name / pole of Ujjain vs Gandhara university town	अवन्तिका / तक्षशिला

5.2 Sixteen Mahajanapadas

#	Mahajanapada	Capital	River / belt
1	Kashi	Varanasi	Ganga
2	Kosala	Shravasti / Ayodhya	Sarayu
3	Anga	Champa	Ganga (port)
4	Magadha (मगध)	Rajagriha → Pataliputra	Ganga + Son
5	Vajji (Vrijji)	Vaishali	Gandak belt
6	Malla	Kushinagar / Pava	Rapti–Gandak edge
7	Chedi	Shuktimati	Ken / Bundelkhand
8	Vatsa	Kaushambi	Yamuna
9	Kuru	Indraprastha / Hastinapur	Yamuna–Ganga doab
10	Panchala	Ahichchhatra / Kampilya	Ganga (Rohilkhand)

#	Mahajanapada	Capital	River / belt
11	Matsya	Viratnagar (Bairat)	Rajasthan
12	Surasena	Mathura	Yamuna
13	Asmaka (Assaka)	Potana / Potali	Godavari (गोदावरी)
14	Avanti	Ujjain / Mahishmati	Shipra / Narmada (नर्मदा)
15	Gandhara (गांधार)	Taxila (also Pushkalavati)	Indus
16	Kamboja	Rajapura	Hindu Kush

5.2a Gana-Sangha Polity — Vajji and Malla

Feature	Gana-sangha (e.g. Vajji, Malla)	Monarchy (e.g. Magadha, Kosala)
Ruler	Clan assembly / oligarchy	Hereditary king
Capital examples	Vaishali, Kushinagar	Rajagriha, Shravasti
Army	Clan levies	Standing chaturanga force
trap	Vajji is not one of the “four monarchies”	Magadha is not a gana

5.3 Mahajanapadas of Uttar Pradesh

State	UP fact
Kashi	Varanasi — oldest continuous city on this list
Kosala	Ayodhya (अयोध्या) + Shravasti (Saheth-Maheth, crescent plan); Prasenajit
Vatsa	Kaushambi (Prayagraj) — Udayana; NBPW + rampart
Kuru	Hastinapur (हस्तिनापुर) (Meerut); Indraprastha = Delhi NCR
Panchala	Ahichchhatra (Bareilly), Kampilya (Farrukhabad); Kanyakubja belt
Malla	Kushinagar + Pava
Surasena	Mathura
Chedi	Banda–Chitrakoot / Bundelkhand — capital Shuktimati / Sotthivati

5.6 Rise of Magadha

Dynasty	Approx. span (Buddhist coaching line)
Haryanka	~544–412 BCE
Shishunaga	~412–344 BCE
Nanda	~344–321 BCE
Maurya	~321–184 BCE
Shunga	~184–75 BCE

5.10 Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)

Ware	Date (approx.)	Key fact
OCP	Late 3rd–2nd millennium BCE	Doab rural, before PGW
PGW	~1100–600 BCE	Later Vedic doab

Ware	Date (approx.)	Key fact
NBPW	~700–200 BCE	Mahajanapada + early historic cities

UP Focus

Mahajanapada	Capital / district fact
Kashi	Varanasi
Kosala	Ayodhya + Shravasti (crescent plan)
Vatsa	Kaushambi (Prayagraj)
Kuru	Hastinapur (Meerut); Indraprastha = Delhi
Panchala	Ahichchhatra (Bareilly), Kampilya; Kanyakubja belt
Malla	Kushinagar
Surasena	Mathura
Chedi	Bundelkhand (Banda–Chitrakoot edge)
UP town (extra)	Kalpi — Yamuna, Jalaun; ancient Kalpriya

Common Traps — Facts

- Matsya = Mathura** → Mathura = **Surasena**; Matsya = **Viratnagar** (2020).
- Asmaka = Pratishthana/Paithan** in that 2020 list → **Potana**.
- Magadha / Vajji / Anga in UP** → **Bihar**.
- Pataliputra founded by Chandragupta / Ashoka** → **Ajatashatru** seeds / founds; **Udayin** first makes it the capital.
- Shishunaga founded Pataliputra** → he **took Avanti** (and some keys give him Varanasi as second capital).
- Shakya = one of the 16** → under Kosala; not the canonical sixteen.
- Alexander defeated the Nandas** → turned at the **Beas**.
- Vajji = Magadhan monarchy** → **gana-sangha**.
- First Magadha conquest = Vajji** → **Anga** (Bimbisara); Vajji = Ajatashatru.
- Kalashoka = First Council** → **Second**, Vaishali.
- Kashi = Kosala** → two mahajanapadas; Varanasi vs Shravasti/Ayodhya.
- Ahichchhatra = Vatsa / Kosala** → **Panchala**; Vatsa = Kaushambi; Kosala = Saket/Shravasti.
- 6th c. BCE = Mauryan empire** → mahajanapadas; Mauryas start ~322 BCE.
- Avanti in UP** → **Malwa / MP**.
- Malla capital = Vaishali** → Vaishali = **Vajji**; Malla = **Kushinagar**.
- Pava (Malla) = Pavapuri (Mahavira)** → two different places.
- NBPW = PGW / “only Mauryan”** → NBPW starts in mahajanapada towns.
- Bimbisara annexed Avanti** → **Shishunaga**.
- Mahapadma = Chandragupta** → Nanda founder vs Mauryan founder.
- Kamboja = Asmaka** → horses/NW vs Godavari/south.
- Shakya = 16th mahajanapada** → under Kosala.
- Jarasandha = Haryanka king** → epic/Puranic Brihadratha memory, not the Bimbisara list.
- Udayin (Magadha) = Udayana (Vatsa)** → capital-shifter vs Kaushambi king.
- Yaudheya = Buddha-age “earlier republic”** → later gana; not in that early list.
- Surasena = Kaushambi** → Mathura; Kaushambi = Vatsa.

26. **First extant coins = gold** → punch-marked **silver** (Aahat).
27. **Kosala capital = Ahichchhatra** → Ahichchhatra = Panchala.

Topic 6 — Foreign Invasions

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Hydaspes	Hyphasis	Jhelum — battle vs Porus vs Beas — mutiny / turn-back	झेलम / ब्यास
Ambhi	Porus	Taxila ally vs Paurava enemy-then-satrap	अंभि / पोरस
Alexander	Seleucus	326 campaign vs ~305 war/treaty with Chandragupta	सिकंदर / सेल्यूकस
Seleucus	Indo-Greeks	Syrian-Bactrian successor of Alexander vs Bactrian Greeks inside India later	सेल्यूकस / इंडो-ग्रीक
Menander	Nagasena	King Milinda vs monk of <i>Milinda Panha</i>	मेनांडर / नागसेन
Menander	Nagarjuna	Indo-Greek king vs Madhyamaka philosopher	मेनांडर / नागार्जुन
Aristotle	Aristobulus	Tutor, never in India vs engineer-historian on the march	अरस्तू / अरिस्टोबुलस
Megasthenes	Nearchus	Seleucid envoy after 303 vs Alexander's admiral	मेगस्थनीज / नियार्कस
Greeks	Sakas	Hellenistic (2nd c. BCE) vs Scythians after them (2023)	यूनानी / शक
Indo-Greek	Kushan	Menander / Sagala vs Kanishka , Purushapura, era 78 CE	इंडो-ग्रीक / कुषाण
Bucephala	Nicaea	City for the horse vs victory-city after Hydaspes	बुसेफला / नीकेया
Kalanos	Dandamis	Gymnosophist who <i>went</i> with Alexander vs the one who refused	कलानोस / दंडामिस
Sagala	Sangala	Menander's Sialkot vs Kathaioi town Alexander stormed	सागल / संगला
Vikrama 57 BCE	Shaka 78 CE	Traditional Vikramaditya vs Kanishka-era count	विक्रम / शक
Agathocles	Menander	Early Brahmi/Vaishnava coin types vs Milinda / Athena types	अगाथोक्लीज / मेनांडर
Maues	Gondophares	Shaka Indo-Scythian first at Taxila vs Parthian Pahlava at Takht-i-Bahi	माउस / गोंडोफेरिस
Nahapana	Rudradaman	Kshaharata, beaten by Gautamiputra vs Kardamaka, Junagadh Sanskrit	नहपान / रुद्रदामन
Kujula Kadphises	Vima Kadphises	Kushan founder/unifier vs gold coin headline	कुजुल / विम
Purushapura	Sagala	Kushan Peshawar capital vs Indo-Greek Sialkot	पुरुषपुर / सागल
Hathigumpha	Junagadh	Kharavela's Kalinga cave vs Rudradaman's Shaka rock	हाथीगुफा / जूनागढ़
Gondophares	Kanishka	Brief Parthian NW vs Kushan empire peak	गोंडोफेरिस / कनिष्क
Demetrius I	Menander	First big Indo-Greek push vs greatest Indo-Greek / Milinda	डेमेट्रियस / मेनांडर
Kujula	Kanishka	Founder / unifier vs imperial climax + era 78 CE	कुजुल / कनिष्क
Gandhara art	Mathura art	NW schist , Greco-Roman vs UP red sandstone , indigenous	गांधार / मथुरा
Kushan dress	Mauryan dhoti look	Coat + trousers + boots vs Indian lower-garment royal memory	कुषाण वेश / धोती
Early Mathura Shiva	Chola Nataraja	Linga / mukhalinga / Oesho under Kushan vs later Tamil bronze dancer	मथुरा शिव / चोल नटराज
Booted Surya	Barefoot South Surya	North Indian udichya-vesa (Shaka–Kushan) vs southern bare legs	सूर्य जूते / दक्षिणी सूर्य

Books and Writers — Foreign Invasions Age

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Anabasis</i> (and related <i>Indica</i>)	Arrian	Alexander's Indian march (draws on Ptolemy and Aristobulus)

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Indica</i> (Mauryan India)	Megasthenes	Seleucid envoy after ~303 BCE; Chandragupta's court
India–Persia notes	Ctesias	Physician to Artaxerxes II
Gymnosophist / march notes	Onesicritus	Helmsman-writer with Alexander
<i>Milinda Panha</i>	Menander (Milinda) and Nagasena	Indo-Greek Buddhist dialogue

6.1 Greek Invasion

Year	Macedonian step
334	Granicus
333	Issus
331	Gaugamela
330	Persepolis
329–327	Bactria–Sogdiana
326	India

6.7 Shakas

Kings — north-west line

- **Maues**, also called **Moga**, is the earliest Indo-Scythian king named in India. He establishes Shaka power in **Gandhara** and around **Taxila**.
- His rule runs on both sides of the Indus, from **Pushkalavati** in the west to **Taxila** in the east. His capital tradition points to **Sirkap**.
- His coins are mostly copper with some silver. Obverse types mix Greek deities with **Shiva** and **Buddha**.
- **Azes I** is the usual successor in numismatic lists. He finishes off remaining Indo-Greek pockets in the Punjab belt.

6.11 Dress, Sculpture, and Iconography under the Foreign Waves

Two art schools

School	Zone	Stone	Look
Gandhara	NW (Peshawar–Taxila–Afghan belt)	Grey / green schist (also stucco)	Greco-Roman Buddha face, wavy hair, heavy drapery
Mathura	Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)	Mottled red sandstone	Indigenous body types, yaksha heritage, smiling / robust figures

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Hydaspes = Beas** → Jhelum = fight; Beas = **stop**.
2. **Alexander beat the Nandas / sat at Pataliputra** → never crossed the Beas.
3. **Ambhi fought at Hydaspes as the enemy** → **ally**; enemy = **Porus**.
4. **Porus was killed** → restored as satrap.
5. **Aristotle / Megasthenes / Chanakya / Deimachus in the Macedonian column** → no (Deimachus = Bindusara envoy).

6. **Megasthenes = Alexander's admiral** → admiral = **Nearchus**; Megasthenes = **Seleucus's envoy**.
7. **Seleucus conquered Magadha** → he **ceded** NW tracts, took **500 elephants**.
8. **Kushans before Sakas** (203 B) → **Greeks** → **Sakas** → **Kushans**.
9. **Nagarjuna wrote Milinda Panha** → **Nagasena**.
10. **Menander = Alexander's general** → 2nd c. BCE Indo-Greek.
11. **Besnagar pillar = Pushyamitra's ashwamedha site** → Besnagar is **Heliodorus**; Pushyamitra's ashwamedha tradition is tied to **Ayodhya** in that stem.
12. **Kanishka = Indo-Greek** → **Kushan** (Purushapura, era 78 CE).
13. **Alexander died at Taxila in 326** → **Babylon, 323**.
14. **First foreigners in the NW = Alexander** → **Achaemenids** (Darius).
15. **Indo-Greek coins = punch-marked karshapana** → die-struck portraits, Greek + Kharoshthi.
16. **Sangala = Sagala** → Kathaioi town Alexander stormed ≠ Menander's Sialkot.
17. **Kalanos = Dandamis** → one went, one refused.
18. **Indo-Greeks introduced Gupta gold dinaras** → portrait silver; **gold = Kushan** headline.
19. **Shaka era = 57 BCE → 78 CE**; 57 BCE = **Vikrama**.
20. **Yavana raid on Pataliputra = Alexander 326** → later Indo-Greek / *Yuga Purana* memory.
21. **Maues = Kushan** → **Shaka** first at Taxila.
22. **Rudradaman = Indo-Greek** → **Shaka** mahakshatrapa; Junagadh Sanskrit.
23. **Nahapana = Kardamaka** → **Kshaharata**; beaten by Gautamiputra.
24. **Gondophares = Shaka** → **Parthian**; Takht-i-Bahi fact.
25. **Fourth Buddhist Council = Ashoka** → **Kanishka**, Kashmir / Vasumitra.
26. **Hathigumpha = Kanishka** (2018 option) → **Kharavela**.
27. **Purushapura = Sagala** → Peshawar Kushan vs Sialkot Indo-Greek.
28. **Massaga women = Kathaioi / Sangala** → Assakenoi capital **Massaga**.
29. **Alexander success = good administrator** → not a standard cause; use no central power + army + traitors.
30. **Kushan kings wore dhoti like Ashoka's pillar figures** → Mat / coin portraits show **coat, trousers, boots**.
31. **Chola Nataraja = Kanishka's Mathura sculpture** → Nataraja is later Tamil bronze; Kushan Mathura = early Shiva linga / Buddha / royal portraits.
32. **Gandhara = red sandstone of Mathura** → Gandhara = **schist** / Greco-Roman NW; Mathura = **red sandstone** UP.
33. **Demetrius = Menander** → Demetrius = early push; Menander = greatest / Milinda.
34. **Vima = founder of Kushans** → founder = **Kujula**; Vima = **gold** headline.

Topic 7 — Mauryan Empire

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Chandragupta Maurya	Chandragupta II	322 BCE founder vs Gupta Vikramaditya	चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य / द्वितीय
Samaharta	Sannidhata	Collects revenue vs stores the kosha	समाहर्ता / संनिधाता
RE XII	RE XIII	Samavaya / religious concord (2022) vs Kalinga	बारहवाँ / तेरहवाँ
RE XIII	Separate Kalinga edicts	Full Kalinga text on most sites vs Dhauili/Jaugada ("all men are my children")	तेरहवाँ / कलिंग पृथक
Major RE	Minor RE	14-set, title Piyadassi vs local; Maski names Ashoka	प्रमुख / लघु
Dhamma	Buddhism	Ethical state policy vs the religion he patronised	धम्म / बौद्ध
Kautilya	Megasthenes	Sanskrit <i>Arthashastra</i> vs Greek <i>Indica</i>	कौटिल्य / मेगस्थनीज
Agronomai	Pautavadyaksha	Rural revenue/land (2020 D) vs weights	एग्रोनोमोई / पौतवाध्यक्ष
Barabar	Ajanta	Mauryan polish, Ajivika gift vs later Buddhist painted caves	बराबर / अजंता
Rajuka	Dhamma-mahamatra	Land/justice (PE) vs moral/welfare cadre (RE V)	राजुक / धम्म-महामात्र
Bherighosha	Dhammaghosha	War-drum vs dhamma-drum (RE IV / XIII)	भेरीघोष / धम्मघोष
RE V	PE V	Dhamma-mahamatras vs protected-animal list	शैल ५ / स्तंभ ५
Six city boards	Six army boards	Crafts/foreigners/census... vs navy/transport/infantry...	नगर षट् / सेना षट्
Bhaga	Bali	Produce share vs extra/religious levy (Rummindei drops <i>bali</i>)	भाग / बलि
Sudama	Lomas Rishi	Polished Ajivika cell vs horseshoe chaitya-arch facade	सुदामा / लोमश ऋषि
Ahaura	Sarnath	UP Minor Rock (Mirzapur) vs UP lion capital	अहौरा / सारनाथ
Kunala	Tivala	Blinded-son legend vs Queen's edict son of Karuvaki	कुणाल / तिवल
Sanstha	Sanchara	Stationary covers vs mobile spies	संस्था / संचार
Moriya kshatriya	Purana shudra	Buddhist Pippalivana origin vs Brahmanical low-birth smear	मोरिय / पुराण

Books and Writers — Mauryan Age

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Arthashastra</i> (अर्थशास्त्र)	Kautilya / Chanakya / Vishnugupta (कौटिल्य / चाणक्य / विष्णुगुप्त)	Sanskrit statecraft; saptanga, officials, courts
<i>Indica</i>	Megasthenes	Greek envoy account of Chandragupta's India (lost; known via Strabo, Arrian)
<i>Mudrarakshasa</i> (मुद्राराक्षस)	Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त)	Sanskrit play on Chandragupta–Chanakya court intrigue
Commentary on <i>Mudrarakshasa</i> (मुद्राराक्षस)	Dhundiraja (धुन्दिराज)	Later commentary on Vishakhadatta's play
<i>Devichandraguptam</i> (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्)	Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त)	Drama remembered with Gupta-age story (same author; later setting)

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Abhisarikavanchitaka</i> (अभिसारिकावंचितक)	Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त)	Another work attributed to the same dramatist
<i>Dipavamsa</i>	Sinhalese Buddhist chronicle	Third Council at Pataliputra under Ashoka
<i>Mahavamsa</i>	Sinhalese Buddhist chronicle	Same council; Moggaliputta Tissa; Lanka missions
<i>Divyavadana</i>	Buddhist anthology	Taxila revolt under Bindusara; Ashoka as <i>kumara</i>
<i>Samantapasadika</i>	Buddhaghosa	Ashoka / Avanti tradition in Bindusara's reign
<i>Ashokavadana</i>	Buddhist tradition	Ashokan succession legends (use lightly)
<i>Vishnu Purana</i>	Puranic tradition	Maurya genealogy (UPPCS 2023)
<i>Manusmriti</i>	Manu tradition	Contrast text: widow remarriage barred; "fallen kshatriyas"
<i>The Prince (Il Principe)</i>	Machiavelli	European compare-text for <i>Arthashastra</i> (not a Mauryan book)
<i>Laghulovada</i> / <i>Rahulovada</i>	Buddhist sutta (not written by Ashoka)	Listed for monks in the Bhabru edict

7.1 Mauryan Empire

King line (overview)

Ruler	Span (approx.)	Must-hold fact
Chandragupta (चंद्रगुप्त)	322–297 BCE	Overthrows Dhana Nanda ; Greek Sandrokottos
Bindusara	297–273 BCE	Greek Amitraghata / Amitrochates
Ashoka	Accedes ~272; crowned 268–232 BCE	Kalinga (कलिंग), dhamma (धम्म), and the edicts
Brihadratha	ends 185 BCE	Killed by Pushyamitra Shunga

Neighbours, pottery, coins, and army size

Named in RE II	Fact
Chola (चोल)	South neighbour
Pandya	South neighbour
Satiyaputra	South neighbour
Keralaputra	South neighbour
Tamraparni	Sri Lanka; neighbour / mission land, not a province
Yonas	Greek / Yavana neighbours
Kambojas	Northwest neighbours

7.5 Important Mauryan Officials

Revenue pair (first swap-trap)

- The **samaharta** collects all revenue.
- The **sannidhata** stores the *kosha* (treasury).
- Never reverse collector and storekeeper.

7.7 Ashoka's Dhamma

The Bhabru / Rahulovada trap

- The **Bhabru** edict (also called **Calcutta-Bairat**) is a message to the **sangha**.
- In it Ashoka lists Buddhist texts for monks. One of them is **Laghulovada** (also called **Rahulovada**).
- So Ashoka **knew** the sutta and valued it for monks.
- Knowing a sutta is **not** the same as defining state Dhamma from that sutta.
- UPPCS **2024** still treats this claim as **false**: "Ashoka's Dhamma definition is taken from *Rahulovada-sutta*."

7.8 Major Rock Edicts

RE	Fact
I	Ban/limit on slaughter and <i>samajas</i> ; royal kitchen cut
II	Hospitals, herbs, wells; Chola–Pandya–Satiyaputra–Keralaputra–Tamraparni named
III	<i>Yukta, rajuka, pradeshika</i> tour every 5 years
IV	Dhammaghosha replaces bherighosha
V	Dhamma-mahamatras created
VI	King reachable at all times; <i>pativedakas</i>
VII	All sects may dwell everywhere
VIII	Dhamma-tours; Bodh Gaya (<i>sambodhi</i>)
IX	Useless rites vs true dhamma
X	Fame only through dhamma
XI	<i>Dhamma-dana</i> (gift of dhamma)
XII	Samavaya / religious synthesis ←
XIII	Kalinga ; five Greek kings (Antioka = Antiochus II Theos of Syria; Turamaya = Ptolemy II Philadelphus of Egypt; Antikini = Antigonos Gonatas of Macedonia; Maka = Magas of Cyrene; Alikasudara = Alexander of Epirus); dhamma-vijaya
XIV	Edicts written short or long as the place needs
Site	Region
-----	-----
Girnar (Junagadh)	Gujarat
Kalsi	Dehradun, Uttarakhand
Dhuli	Odisha
Jaugada	Odisha
Shahbazgarhi	KP, Pakistan
Mansehra	KP, Pakistan
Sopara (शूर्पारिक)	Maharashtra
Erragudi / Yerragudi	Andhra
Sannati (Kanaganahalli)	Karnataka

7.10 Pillar Edicts

PE	Fact
I	Self-check; little sin
II	Defines dhamma (compassion, liberality, truth, purity)
III	Deeds vs mere rites
IV	Rajukas independent justice; capital cases
V	Closed slaughter-days; list of protected animals (not dhamma-mahamatras — those are RE V)
VI	Inscriptions from the 12th year onward
VII	Longest; “gift of dhamma is the best gift”; only on Delhi-Topra in full
Shaft	Place
-----	-----
Sarnath	Varanasi, UP
Sanchi	MP
Vaishali (Bakhira)	Bihar
Sankissa	Farrukhabad belt
Lauriya-Nandangarh / Araraj	Bihar
Rampurva	Bihar
Rummindei	Lumbini, Nepal
Nigali Sagar	Nepal
Allahabad (इलाहाबाद)	from Kaushambi , UP
Delhi-Topra	from Topra, Haryana
Delhi-Meerut	from Meerut , UP

7.11 Cave Architecture of Mauryan Period

Cave	Hill	Patron	Fact
Sudama	Barabar	Ashoka, 12th year	Polished cell; Ajivika
Lomas Rishi	Barabar	(facade; no Ashokan text)	Horseshoe chaitya-arch — prototype of Bhaja/Karle/Ajanta fronts
Vishvakarma (Visva Zopri)	Barabar	Ashoka	Ajivika
Karan Chaupar	Barabar	Ashoka, 19th year	Rain-retreat for Ajivikas
Gopika, Vapiyaka, Vadathika	Nagarjuni	Dasharatha	Still Ajivika (आजीविक)

7.15 Provincial Administration

Province	HQ	Governor
Prachyapatha / Magadha core	Pataliputra	King
Uttarapatha	Taxila	Kumara
Avantiratha / Avantirashtra	Ujjain	Kumara
Kalinga (after 261)	Tosali (+ Samapa)	Kumara / mahamatra

Province	HQ	Governor
Dakshinapatha (दक्षिणापथ)	Suvarnagiri	Kumara

7.16 Revenue Administration

Levy	Fact
Bhaga	Produce share; Arthashastra 1/6 (<i>shadbhaga</i>)
Bali	Extra / religious levy; Rummindei drops it
Hiranya	Cash
Shulka	Toll / customs (<i>sulkadhyaksha</i>)
Vishti (विष्टि -)	Forced labour
Udakabhaga	Irrigation cess
Pranaya	Emergency / benevolence tax (UKPCS 2021)
Sita	Crown-farm produce (<i>sitadhyaksha</i>)
Vivit	Pasture tax (<i>vivitadhyaksha</i>)

UP Focus

Fact	Place
Ahaura MRE	Mirzapur (मिर्ज़ापुर) — UP's own Minor Rock Edict
Sarnath pillar / four-lion capital	Varanasi — national emblem
Schism edict	Sarnath + Kaushambi
Allahabad pillar	Originally Kaushambi ; now Prayagraj (Ashoka + Gupta + Jahangir)
Meerut pillar	Origin Meerut (मेरठ); Firoz Shah moved it to Delhi
Sankissa elephant capital	Farrukhabad belt
Kashi-Kosala-Vatsa	Inside the imperial core , not a kumara-province
Kushinagar	Mauryan-period Buddhist site (Malla); not an edict site
Birth story	Magadha / Moriya; not "Ashoka of UP"

Common Traps — Facts

- RE XII vs XIII** → XII = synthesis (2022); XIII = Kalinga.
- Rahulovada** = Ashoka's dhamma definition → **false** (2024).
- Agronomai** = roads / weights → **revenue** (2020); roads are the Strabo extra.
- Maski** = Girnar Major set → Maski = **MRE** that **names** Ashoka.
- Sannidhata collects tax** → he **stores**; Samaharta collects.
- Chandragupta Maurya** = **Chandragupta II** → 322 BCE vs Gupta.
- Barabar** = **Buddhist Ajanta** / 6th c. **BCE** → **Ajivika**, Mauryan polish.
- Sarnath lions** = **Sanchi stupa** → emblem = **Sarnath**; "best stupa" often = **Sanchi**.
- Megasthenes with Alexander** → Seleucus's envoy.
- Indica's seven castes** = **varna** → Greek seven-fold sketch; philosophers = Brahman + Shramana.
- Chola/Pandya / Sri Lanka** = **Mauryan provinces** → **neighbours** in RE II.
- Vayu Purana** = **Gupta administration** → 2023 stmt 2 false.

13. **Ashoka's death = end of empire** → lasts to **185** (Brihadratha).
14. **Arthashastra = Indica** → Kautilya vs Megasthenes.
15. **Allahabad pillar is only Gupta** → Mauryan shaft, later reused.
16. **Dhauili/Jaugada print full RE XIII** → they carry **separate Kalinga edicts** instead.
17. **Punch-marked coins = Ashoka's portrait issues** → anonymous *karshapana*; portraits = Indo-Greek.
18. **Didarganj Yakshi = Gupta Sarnath Buddha** → Mauryan-polish Patna figure (date debated).
19. **Prinsep 1837** reads Brahmi; Maski later proves Piyadassi = Ashoka.
20. **PE V = dhamma-mahamatras** → that is **RE V**; PE V = **animals**.
21. **Ahaura = Sarnath lions** → Ahaura = **Mirzapur MRE**.
22. **Lomas Rishi donated by Ashoka in writing** → famous **facade**; Sudama/Karan Chaupar carry Ashokan Ajivika grants.
23. **Bhabru Laghulovada proves 2024 stmt 1** → listed as a *monk-text*, not the definition of state Dhamma.
24. **Indica "no slavery" = Arthashastra** → they **clash**.
25. **Six city boards = six army boards = 18 tirthas** → three different lists.
26. **Girnar is only Ashokan** → same rock later has **Rudradaman**.
27. **Vaishali pillar carries the seven PE** → single lion, **no** edict.
28. **Chola/Keralaputra = kumara provinces** → **neighbours** (RE II).
29. **Kunala is as epigraphic as Tivala** → Tivala is on the Queen's edict; Kunala is legend.
30. **Pranaya = ordinary land tax** → **emergency** tax (UKPCS 2021).
31. **Sita = goddess in revenue stems** → crown-land produce.
32. **Turamaya = Syria** → **Egypt** (Ptolemy II).
33. **Mauryas started religious land grants** → Satavahana epigraphy; Mauryas did not.
34. **Vishnugupta = Vishakhadatta** → Chanakya's other name.
35. **Sudarshana founded by Rudradaman** → built under **Chandragupta**; Rudradaman **repairs**.
36. **Third Council = Ashokan edicts** → *Dipavamsa* / *Mahavamsa*.
37. **Parkham Yaksha unnamed** → inscribed **Manibhadra**.
38. **Kumrahar / Bulandibagh = Vaishali** → **Pataliputra**.

Topic 8 — Post-Mauryan India

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Indo-Greek	Shaka	Hellenistic Menander vs Central Asian Maues / Rudradaman	इंडो-ग्रीक / शक
Shaka	Kushan	After Greeks, before Kushan vs Kanishka empire	शक / कुषाण
Shunga	Satavahana	Magadha north vs Deccan Andhra	शुंग / सातवाहन
Kharavela	Rudradaman	Hathigumpha Kalinga vs Junagadh Shaka	खारवेल / रुद्रदामन
Ayodhya inscription	Besnagar pillar	Pushyamitra ashwamedha vs Heliodorus Bhagavata	अयोध्या / बेसनगर
Vikrama 57 BCE	Shaka 78 CE	Traditional Vikramaditya vs Kanishka-era count	विक्रम / शक
Karikala	Rajaraja I	Sangam Chola, Kallanai vs imperial Chola, Thanjavur	करिकाल / राजराज
Mahendravarman I	Rajaraja I	Pallava vs Chola (2025 swap trap)	महेन्द्रवर्मन / राजराज
Kadungon	Amoghavarsha I	Pandya revival vs Rashtrakuta	कडुंगो / अमोघवर्ष
Akam	Puram	Inner love poetry vs outer war / kingship	अकम् / पुरम्
Gandhara art	Amaravati art	Kushan NW Greco-Buddhist vs Satavahana Andhra limestone	गांधार / अमरावती
Sangam Chola	Imperial Chola	Karikala age vs 9th–11th c. revival	संगम चोल / साम्राज्य चोल
Muvendar	Satavahana	Chera-Chola-Pandya vs north-Deccan Andhra house	मुवेन्दर / सातवाहन
Nahapana	Rudradaman	Kshaharata, beaten by Gautamiputra vs Kardamaka, Junagadh	नहपान / रुद्रदामन
Purushapura	Mathura	Kushan main capital vs second Indian capital	पुरुषपुर / मथुरा
Vaigai (Pandya)	Vengi (Andhra)	Madurai Pandya river vs Eastern Chalukya capital Pedavegi near Eluru	वैगई / वेंगी
Arikamedu / Poduke	Tamralipti	Coromandel Roman station vs Ganga-mouth Bay port	अरिकामेडु / ताम्रलिप्ति
Muvendar	Pallava / Kadamba	Sangam trio only vs later Kanchi / Vanavasi houses	मुवेन्दर / पल्लव-कदम्ब

Books and Writers — Post-Mauryan Age

Book / text	Writer / authority	Horizon / use
<i>Mahabhashya</i> (महाभाष्य)	Patanjali (पतंजलि)	Shunga-age grammar; not Kanishka's court
<i>Malavikagnimitra</i> (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्)	Kalidasa (कालिदास)	Play on Agnimitra (अग्निमित्र) (Pushyamitra's son); Shunga setting
<i>Gatha Saptasati</i>	Hala	Prakrit anthology; Satavahana court
<i>Milinda Panha</i>	Dialogue of Menander (Milinda) and Nagasena	Indo-Greek Buddhist Q&A
<i>Buddhacharita</i>	Ashvaghosha	Buddha's life epic; Kanishka age
<i>Saundarananda</i>	Ashvaghosha	Same court circle
<i>Sariputraprakarana</i>	Ashvaghosha	Same court circle
<i>Tolkappiyam</i>	Tolkappiyar tradition	Earliest Tamil grammar and poetics; Sangam age
<i>Silappadikaram</i>	Ilango Adigal	Kannagi-Kovalan epic; later Sangam edge

Book / text	Writer / authority	Horizon / use
<i>Manimekalai</i> (मणिमेकलै)	Sattanar (सत्तनार)	Buddhist sequel to Silappadikaram
<i>Tirukkural</i> (Kural / Muppal)	Tiruvalluvar	Called Laghuveda / Bible of Tamil ethics
<i>Ramavataram</i>	Kamban	Tamil Ramayana (later medieval Tamil classic)
<i>Periplus of the Erythraean Sea</i>	Anonymous Greek merchant	Red Sea / Indian Ocean trade handbook; Poduke = Arikamedu
<i>Matsya Purana</i>	Puranic tradition	Longest Andhra / Satavahana king list (~30)
<i>Vayu Purana</i>	Puranic tradition	Kanva end / Andhra founder memory

8.2 Satavahana Rulers

Gautamiputra Satakarni vs Nahapana — Cause, Course, Result

Ruler	Fact
Simuka	Traditional founder after Kanva Susharma
Satakarni I	Early expansion; Naneghat of queen Naganika
Gautamiputra Satakarni	Greatest; defeats Nahapana ; Ekabrahmana / varna protector; Nasik of Gautami Balashri
Vashishthiputra Pulumavi	Son and successor
Hala	<i>Gatha Saptasati</i> in Prakrit
Yajna Sri Satakarni	Ship on coins — sea-trade fact

8.3 South Indian History

Megalithic south

- **Megalithic** cultures are Iron Age burial traditions of the peninsula and parts of central India.
- They predate and underlie the Sangam polities.
- Burial types include **dolmens**, **cists**, stone circles, capstones, and **hero stones (virakkal / nadukal)** for warriors.
- Pottery is often **black-and-red ware (BRW)**.
- Iron tools and weapons appear in the graves.
- Major sites include **Brahmagiri**, **Adichanallur**, **Maski**, **Hallur**, **Nevasa**, and **Piklihal**.
- Brahmagiri links megalithic layers to early historic transitions.
- **PGW** is Later Vedic **doab** (दोआब) ware. **Megaliths** are mainly **south and Deccan** Iron Age burials.
- Grave goods can include pottery, iron weapons, gold, and beads.
- Some sites show communal or family burials under large stone slabs.

8.3b Post-Mauryan Art Schools — Quick Compare

School	Period / patron	Material / style	Key fact
Gandhara	Kushan northwest	Greco-Buddhist green schist	Greco-Roman Buddha face; Indo-Greek bridge
Mathura	Kushan / local	Red sandstone Indian types	Indigenous Buddha forms
Amaravati	Satavahana Andhra	Limestone narrative reliefs	Andhra Buddhist stupa art
Karle / Nasik	Satavahana age	Rock-cut chaitya (चैत्य) halls	Public Buddhist architecture

8.9 Sangam Age

Sangam	Place	President / tradition
First	Madurai	Saint Agastya (with Tolkappiyar in some lists)
Second	Kapadapuram	Saint Agastya
Third	Madurai	Nakkirar

Kingdom	Emblem	Capital	Port	Famous king
Chera	Bow	Vanji / Vanchi / Karur (Karuvur)	Muziris (Muchiri) ; also Tondi	Senguttuvan; Udiyanjiral (early Chera)
Chola	Tiger	Uraiyur	Puhar / Kaveripattinam	Karikala
Pandya	Fish	Madurai	Korkai	Nedunjeliyan

UP Focus

Fact	Place
Ayodhya ashwamedha inscription	Ayodhya — Pushyamitra fact
Mathura	Kushan second capital . Mathura art
Sarnath	Not the Pushyamitra ashwamedha record
Deep-south Sangam	Not a UP polity. Ports are Tamilakam

Common Traps — Facts

- Kushans before Shakas** (2023 B) → Greeks → Sakas → Kushans.
- Hathigumpha = Ashoka / Kanishka / Harsha → Kharavela.**
- Pushyamitra ashwamedha = Besnagar / Hathigumpha → Ayodhya.**
- Satavahanas = Sanskrit-first / gold coins → Prakrit**; metals include lead/copper/silver/potini, **not gold**.
- Karikala = Rajaraja I** → Sangam vs imperial Chola.
- Mahendravarman = Chola → Pallava** (2025).
- Rajaraja = Pallava → Chola.**
- Shaka era = 57 BCE → 78 CE**; Vikrama = 57 BCE; difference **135**.
- Patanjali = Kanishka court → Shunga / Mahabhashya.**
- Rabatak lists Shravasti** → Saketa, Kaushambi, Pataliputra, Champa — **not Shravasti**.
- Sudarshana founded by Rudradaman** → built under Chandragupta; repaired **without forced labour**.
- Vima = copper only / Kujula = gold** → reverse: Vima = gold; Kujula = copper.
- Milinda contemporary of Bimbisara** → Indo-Greek, centuries later.
- Strato II = silver only** → remembered for **lead**.
- Satavahana capital = only Amaravati** → lasting capital **Pratishthana**.
- Ekabrahmana = Pushyamitra → Gautamiputra Satakarni.**
- Kushan navy explains Red Sea trade** → trade yes; navy claim false.
- Gandhara = red sandstone → green schist**; Mathura = red sandstone.
- Hathigumpha = Khandagiri → Udayagiri** (18 caves); Khandagiri has 15.
- Yaudheya coins = Vasudeva → Kartikeya + peacock.**
- Kadungon = Rashtrakuta → Pandya.**
- Milinda's monk = Nagarjuna → Nagasena.**
- Gondophares = Kushan → Parthian.**

24. **Purushapura = Mathura** → Peshawar main; Mathura second.
25. **Muvendar includes Pallava** → Chera, Chola, Pandya only.
26. **Akam = war** → Akam = love; Puram = war.
27. **Junagadh = Hathigumpha** → Gujarat Shaka vs Odisha Kalinga.
28. **Simuka = Kushan founder** → Satavahana; Kushan founder = **Kujula**.
29. **Fourth Council = Ashoka** → **Kanishka** / Kashmir; Ashoka = Third.
30. **Heliodorus = Pushyamitra's ashwamedha clerk** → Bhagavata envoy of Antialcidas.
31. **Sangam = Satavahana dynasty** → Tamil literary age; different house.
32. **Kon / Ko / Mannan = minister** → **king**.
33. **Third Sangam president = Agastya** → **Nakkirar**; First/Second = Agastya tradition.
34. **Yavanapriya = muslin / ivory** → **pepper**.
35. **Poduke = Tamralipti** → **Arikamedu**.
36. **Uraiyur = pepper / Pandya capital** → Sangam **Chola** capital and **cotton** centre.
37. **Kadamba / Pallava = Sangam Muvendar** → Chera, Chola, Pandya only.
38. **Vattakirutal = peaceful court debate** → defeated king's **fast unto death**.
39. **Pandya river = Godavari / Krishna Vengi** → **Vaigai** core (MCQ "Vengi" ≠ Eastern Chalukya Vengi).
40. **Tolkappiyam = astronomy / law code** → **grammar and poetry**.
41. **Silappadikaram = Sattanar** → **Ilango Adigal**; Sattanar = *Manimekalai*.
42. **Kural = Greek / Telugu** → **Tamil**; Laghuveda / Muppall by Tiruvalluvar.

Topic 9 — Gupta Age

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Chandragupta I	Chandragupta II	Licchavi marriage founder vs Vikramaditya , Shaka war	प्रथम / द्वितीय
Chandragupta II	Chandragupta Maurya	Gupta ~380 CE vs Mauryan 322 BCE	गुप्त / मौर्य
Samudragupta	Chandragupta II	Digvijaya / Prayag vs Shaka silver + Fa-Hien	समुद्रगुप्त / चंद्रगुप्त II
Prayag Prashasti	Allahabad pillar	Harishena's text vs the shaft it sits on	प्रशस्ति / स्तंभ
Gold dinara	Silver rupaka	Prestige types vs 2022 Shaka-victory proof (~33 grains)	दीनार / रूपक
Bhukti	Vishaya	Province (Uparika) vs district (Kumaramatya)	भुक्ति / विषय
Kalidasa	Bhartrihari	<i>Meghaduta</i> (मेघदूत) / <i>Raghuvamsa</i> (रघुवंश) vs Shringara Shataka (शृंगार शतक) (2025)	कालिदास / भर्तृहरि
Fa-Hien	Hiuen Tsang	CG II ~400 CE vs Harsha ~630s	फाह्यान / ह्वेन त्सांग
Kumaragupta I	Skandagupta	Nalanda patron vs Huna wars (Bhitari)	कुमारगुप्त / स्कंदगुप्त
Somadeva	Kshemendra	<i>Kathasaritsagara</i> vs <i>Brihatkathamajari</i> (2025)	सोमदेव / क्षेमेन्द्र
Jayadeva	Trivikrama Bhatta	<i>Gita Govinda</i> vs <i>Nala Champu</i> (2025)	जयदेव / त्रिविक्रम
Aryabhata	Varahamihira	<i>Aryabhatiya</i> , rotation vs <i>Brihatsamhita</i>	आर्यभट / वराहमिहिर
Sarnath Buddha	Gandhara Buddha	Gupta plain drape vs Kushan Greco-Buddhist	सारनाथ / गांधार
Sandhivivrahika	Samaharta	Gupta peace-and-war minister vs Mauryan collector	संधिविग्रहिक / समाहर्ता
Nalanda	Takshashila	Gupta Kumaragupta I vs older Gandhara town	नालंदा / तक्षशिला
Vikramashila	Vallabhi	Pala Dharmapala vs Maitraka Gujarat (also Jain council)	विक्रमशिला / वल्लभी
Gold dinara	Silver rupaka	Prestige types vs Shaka-victory proof (~33 grains)	दीनार / रूपक
Dhanvantari	Bhaskara II	Navaratna medicine vs 12th-c. <i>Lilavati</i>	धन्वंतरि / भास्कर
Eran sati	Junagadh	Goparaja widow ~510 CE vs Rudradaman / Skandagupta lake texts	एरण सती / जूनागढ़
Tamralipti	Bhrigukachchha	East Bengal port vs west Bharuch port	ताम्रलिप्ति / भृगुकच्छ
Pravarasena I	Prabhavati	Vakataka Samrat / 4 ashvamedhas vs Gupta princess-regent	प्रवरसेन / प्रभावती
Devagupta	Chandragupta Maurya	CG II alias vs Mauryan founder	देवगुप्त / मौर्य
Vishti	Bhaga	Forced labour as tax vs produce share (~1/6)	विष्टि / भाग

Books and Writers — Gupta Age

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Abhijnanashakuntalam</i> (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), <i>Malavikagnimitra</i> (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्), <i>Vikramorvasiyam</i> (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्)	Kalidasa (कालिदास)	Gupta dramas (नाटक); CG II court tradition
<i>Raghuvamsa</i> (रघुवंश), <i>Kumarasambhava</i> (कुमारसंभव)	Kalidasa (कालिदास)	Mahakavyas (महाकाव्य)

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Meghaduta</i> (मेघदूत), <i>Ritusamhara</i> (ऋतुसंहार)	Kalidasa (कालिदास)	Lyrics (गीतिकाव्य)
<i>Shringara Shataka</i> (शृंगार शतक)	Bhartrihari (भर्तृहरि)	Not Kalidasa
<i>Amarakosha</i> (अमरकोश)	Amarasimha (अमरसिंह)	Lexicon; Navaratna name
<i>Mrichchhakatika</i> (मृच्छकटिकम्)	Sudraka (शूद्रक)	Charudatta (चारुदत्त)– Vasantasena (वसन्तसेना)
<i>Mudrarakshasa</i> (मुद्राराक्षस), <i>Devichandraguptam</i> (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्)	Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त)	Chanakya play; Ramagupta story
<i>Kamasutra</i> (कामसूत्र)	Vatsyayana (वात्स्यायन)	Gupta-age Sanskrit treatise
<i>Panchatantra</i> (पंचतंत्र)	Vishnu Sharma (विष्णु शर्मा) (tradition)	Fable cycle
<i>Kiratarjuniya</i> (किरातार्जुनीय)	Bharavi (भारवि)	Late Gupta / after
<i>Aryabhatiya</i> (आर्यभटीय)	Aryabhata (आर्यभट)	499 CE; maths / astronomy
<i>Panchasiddhantika</i> (पंचसिद्धांतिका), <i>Brihatsamhita</i> (बृहत्संहिता)	Varahamihira (वराहमिहिर)	Astronomy / encyclopaedia
<i>Brahmasphutasiddhanta</i> (ब्रह्मस्फुटसिद्धान्त)	Brahmagupta (ब्रह्मगुप्त)	Early 7th c. edge of the age
<i>Setubandha</i> (सेतुबन्ध) (<i>Ravanavaho</i> (रावणवहो))	Pravarasena II (प्रवरसेन द्वितीय)	Vakataka Prakrit
Prayag Prashasti (प्रयाग प्रशस्ति)	Harishena (हरिषेण)	Samudragupta's literary eulogy
<i>Nala Champu</i> (नल चम्पू)	Trivikrama Bhatta (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट)	Later match pair
<i>Kathasaritsagara</i> (कथासरित्सागर)	Somadeva (सोमदेव)	Later match pair
<i>Gita Govinda</i> (गीत गोविंद)	Jayadeva (जयदेव)	Later match pair
<i>Brihatkathamajari</i> (बृहत्कथामंजरी)	Kshemendra (क्षेमेन्द्र)	Later match pair

9.3 Samudragupta's Military Campaigns

South kings often matched

King	Kingdom
Dhananjaya (धनंजय)	Kusthalapura
Nilaraja	Avamukta
Ugrasena (उग्रसेन)	Palaka / Palakka
Vishnugopa	Kanchi

North, frontier, and gana tribute

- North names in the uprooted set include Ganapatinaga, **Nagasena** (नागसेन), **Achyuta**, **Chandravarman**, and **Balavarman**.
- Frontier tribute includes Samatata, **Davaka**, **Kamarupa**, **Nepala**, and **Karttripura**.
- Ganarajya tribute includes Malava, **Yaudheya**, **Arjunayana**, and **Madraka**.

Logic: South = **tribute and restore**. North = **uproot**. Vishnugopa ≠ a Magadha king.

9.8 Gupta Administration System

Level	Unit	Officer
Empire		Maharajadhiraja
Province	Bhukti	Uparika
District	Vishaya	Kumaramatya / Ayuktaka
Sub-district	Vithi	local notables / <i>vithi-mahattara</i>
Village	Grama	Gramika / <i>ashtakuladhikarana</i>

9.9 Gupta Inscriptions

Record	Ruler	Fact
Prayag Prashasti	Samudragupta	Harishena. Campaigns in 9.3
Allahabad pillar (इलाहाबाद स्तंभ)	(the shaft)	Ashoka + prashasti in 9.14
Mehrauli iron pillar	Chandra = CG II in most keys	Rust-resistant iron
Bhitari pillar	Skandagupta	Huna war; Ghazipur, UP
Udayagiri	CG II / Kumaragupta	Vaishnava caves
Eran	Samudragupta / later Buddhagupta–Bhanugupta	Varaha; sati of Goparaja's widow (~510 CE)
Damodarpur plates	Later imperial Guptas	Kumaramatya. Land grants
Mandasor / Dashpur	Kumaragupta age / silk weavers	Sun temple; Bandhuvarman. Yashodharman's later Huna boast is a different Mandasor text

9.11 Gupta Gold Coins

Type	Usual king
King and queen (Kumaradevi)	Chandragupta I
Ashvamedha horse	Samudragupta
Lyrical / veena	Samudragupta
Battle-axe / <i>parashu</i>	Samudragupta
Tiger-slayer (<i>vyaghra</i>)	Samudragupta
Standard / Garuda types	Samudragupta (in the famous six-type set)
Archer	Chandragupta II (commonest)
Chhatra / lion-slayer	Chandragupta II
Lion-slayer / peacock	Kumaragupta I
King fighting lion	Skandagupta

9.15 Nalanda University

University	Region	Founder / patron fact
Takshashila	Gandhara	Pre-Mauryan teaching town; Panini grammar
Nalanda	Bihar	Kumaragupta I founder-patron

University	Region	Founder / patron fact
Vikramashila	Bengal–Bihar belt	Pala Dharmapala
Vallabhi	Gujarat	Maitraka ; Jain Svetambara council

9.17 Gupta Literature

Navaratnas (later tradition)

Gem	Field
Kalidasa (कालिदास)	Poetry and drama
Amarasimha (अमरसिंह)	<i>Amarakosha</i> (अमरकोश) (lexicon)
Varahamihira (वराहमिहिर)	Astronomy (<i>Panchasiddhantika</i> (पंचसिद्धांतिका), <i>Brihatsamhita</i> (बृहत्संहिता)) — actually 6th century
Dhanvantari (धन्वंतरि)	Medicine
Vararuchi (वररुचि)	Grammar
Ghatakarpura (घटकर्पूर)	Poetry
Kshapanaka (क्षपणक)	Astrology
Shanku (शंकु)	Architecture
Vetala Bhatta (वेताल भट्ट)	Magic / counsel

Writer	Book
Trivikrama Bhatta (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट)	Nala Champu (नल चम्पू)
Somadeva (सोमदेव)	Kathasaritsagara (कथासरित्सागर)
Jayadeva (जयदेव)	Gita Govinda (गीत गोविंद)
Kshemendra (क्षेमेन्द्र)	Brihatkathamajari (बृहत्कथामंजरी)

9.21 Ancient Universities — Full Four-Way Card

University	Region	Patron / age	Subjects & facts	End / trap
Takshashila (Taxila)	Gandhara (NW)	Pre-Mauryan; Chanakya , Panini	Grammar, medicine, politics	Damaged by Hunas (~5th c.)
Nalanda	Bihar	Kumaragupta I ; Pala peak	Buddhist philosophy, logic; Xuanzang studied here	Bakhtiyar Khalji ~1193
Vikramashila	Bhagalpur belt	Pala Dharmapala (~8th c.)	Mahayana, Tantra; Atisa taught here	Destroyed ~12th c.
Vallabhi	Gujarat	Maitraka rulers	Brahmanical + Jain; Svetambara Jain council (~5th c.)	Not Vaishali; not Buddhist 2nd council

UP Focus

Fact	Place
Allahabad / Prayag pillar	Prayagraj — Ashoka + Karuvaki + Harishena + Jahangir
Bhitari Huna pillar	Ghazipur , UP — Skandagupta
Bhitargaon brick temple	Kanpur belt
Sarnath Gupta Buddha	Varanasi

Fact	Place
Kaushambi origin of the Allahabad shaft	Kaushambi
Fa-Hien's Ganga plain	includes the UP stretch of the empire
Eran sati / Varaha	Madhya Pradesh (not UP) — still a must-score inscription

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Chandragupta II = Chandragupta Maurya** → Gupta Vikramaditya vs 322 BCE.
2. **2022 Shaka proof = gold dinara** → **silver**, ~33 grains.
3. **33 grains = gold weight** → silver rupaka.
4. **Samudragupta annexed the south** → restored **tributes**.
5. **Vishnugopa = Magadha** → **Kanchi**.
6. **Dhananjaya = Avamukta** → **Kusthalapura**. Nilaraja = Avamukta.
7. **Prayag Prashasti = the pillar itself** → the **text**. Shaft is Ashokan.
8. **Shringara Shataka = Kalidasa** → **Bhartrihari** (2025).
9. **Fa-Hien = Hiuen Tsang** → ~400 vs ~630. 2024 order Fa-Hien first.
10. **Nalanda = Fa-Hien's main campus memoir** → founder fact **Kumaragupta**. Xuanzang = later.
11. **Vayu Purana = Gupta admin** → 2023 stmt 2 false.
12. **Sarnath Buddha = Gandhara** → Gupta vs Kushan.
13. **Ajanta = default Gupta court painting** → largely **Vakataka**.
14. **Jayadeva sat with Kalidasa** → 2025 match only. Later poet.
15. **Bhitari = Samudragupta south list** → **Skandagupta / Hunas**.
16. **Sandhivigraha = Samaharta** → Gupta war-peace vs Mauryan collector.
17. **King-queen gold = Chandragupta II Shaka type** → **Chandragupta I** + Kumaradevi.
18. **Lyrist coin = Chandragupta II** → **Samudragupta**.
19. **Allahabad pillar is only Gupta** → Mauryan shaft reused.
20. **Maukhari pairs treated as imperial Gupta** → Ishanavarman / Jivitagupta II are **later**. **Sarvavarman ≠ Gaya** plate.
21. **Chapter starts at Chandragupta II** → Sri Gupta → Ghatotkacha → **Chandragupta I** first.
22. **Ramagupta = hard inscription king** → play-trap (*Devichandraguptam*).
23. **Devagupta = Chandragupta Maurya** → Devagupta is an alias of **Chandragupta II**.
24. **Lilavati = Dhanvantari / Gupta maths** → **Bhaskara II**, 12th century.
25. **Bhitari = outside UP** → **Ghazipur**, Uttar Pradesh.
26. **Admin ladder skips Vithi** → Bhukti → Vishaya → **Vithi** → Grama.
27. **Eran sati = Rudradaman** → Goparaja's widow ~510 CE.
28. **Tamralipti = only west port** → east Bengal; west = **Bharuch**.
29. **Pravarasena I = four ashvamedhas of Samudragupta** → **Vakataka** king.
30. **Mehrauli = Ashoka pillar only** → iron **Vishnu dhvaja** of Chandra / CG II.

Topic 10 — Post-Gupta Period

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Gupta	Post-Gupta	Imperial ~320–550 vs fragment then Harsha	गुप्त / उत्तर-गुप्त
Thanesar	Kannauj	Early capital Haryana vs later capital UP	थानेसर / कन्नौज
Banabhatta	Kalidasa	Harsha's prose vs Gupta poetry/drama	बाणभट्ट / कालिदास
Harshacharita	Kadambari	Harsha biography vs romance (same Bana)	हर्षचरित / कादम्बरी
Harshacharita	Si-Yu-Ki	Sanskrit kavya vs Xuanzang's Chinese record	हर्षचरित / सी-यू-की
Fa-Hien	Hiuen Tsang	CG II ~400 vs Harsha ~ 630	फाह्यान / ह्वेन त्सांग
Hiuen Tsang	I-Tsing	Harsha's guest vs after Harsha, still Nalanda	ह्वेन त्सांग / इ-त्सिंग
Pulakeshin II	Shashanka	Narmada Chalukya stop vs Gauda who killed the brother	पुलकेशिन / शशांक
Maukhari	Pushyabhuti	Kannauj house vs Thanesar house	मौखरी / पुष्यभूति
Ishanavarman	Ishvaravarman	Haraha 554 CE vs father. Jaunpur in 2022 key	ईशानवर्मन / ईश्वरवर्मन
Haraha	Gaya copper plate	Maukhari Ishanavarman vs Samudragupta plate (2022 trap)	हराहा / गया
Harsha	Kharavela	7th c. Kannauj vs Hathigumpha (2018 trap C)	हर्ष / खारवेल
Mathura cotton	Varanasi silk	Xuanzang textile pair	मथुरा कपास / वाराणसी रेशम
Kausheya	Cotton	Silk cloth word vs ordinary cotton	कौशेय / कपास
Hundi	Royal edict	Bill of exchange vs king's order	हुंडी / आज्ञा
Sung-yun	Fa-Hien	~518 Wei envoy vs CG II pilgrim ~400	सुंगयुन / फाह्यान
Harsha	Shankaracharya	7th c. Kannauj king vs 8th c. Advaita maths	हर्ष / शंकर

Books and Writers — Post-Gupta / Harsha Age

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Harshacharita</i>	Banabhatta	Prose biography (<i>akhyayika</i>) of Harsha
<i>Kadambari</i>	Banabhatta (finished by Bhushanabhatta)	Prose romance (<i>katha</i>)
<i>Suryashataka</i>	Mayura	Same Harsha court; not Bana
<i>Nagananda</i> , <i>Ratnavali</i> , <i>Priyadarshika</i>	Attributed to Harsha	Court plays; <i>Nagananda</i> has Buddhist flavour
<i>Si-Yu-Ki (Xiyu Ji)</i>	Hiuen Tsang / Xuanzang	Chinese record of Harsha's India
<i>Nanhai Jigui Neifa Zhuan</i>	I-tsing (Yijing)	Post-Harsha Nalanda / sea-route account
<i>Kitab-ul-Hind</i>	Al-Biruni	~1017; last in the usual traveller order
<i>Rajatarangini</i>	Kalhana (कल्हण)	Later Kashmir chronicle (Huna / Harsha-age memory)

10.4 Policies of Harshavardhana

South — Pulakeshin II (Cause, Course, Result)

Cause: Harsha pushed south from Kannauj and tried to cross into the Deccan.

Course: Pulakeshin II of Vatapi stopped him about **630–634 CE**. The **Aihole inscription** of **Ravikirti** on the **Meguti** temple records that boast. Some copper-plate readings push the clash toward **618 CE**; the stopper remains Pulakeshin II.

Result: The **Narmada** becomes Harsha’s effective southern line. He never becomes a Deccan emperor.

UP Focus

Fact	Place
Kannauj	Later Harsha capital
Haraha inscription	Barabanki — Ishanavarman
Jaunpur stone	Ishvaravarman in the 2022 key
Prayag charity	Prayagraj — Xuanzang
Pritikuta / Shravasti	Bana’s home
Thanesar	Haryana . Not UP
Deo-Baranark	Bihar — Jivitagupta II. Not a UP site
Aphsad inscription	Bihar — Adityasena. Not a UP site
Banskhera plate	Shahjahanpur, UP — Harsha grant with signature

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Harsha = Gupta emperor** → Pushyabhuti / Vardhana.
2. **Thanesar = Kannauj** → early Haryana seat vs later **UP** capital.
3. **Thanesar is in UP** → **Haryana**.
4. **Fa-Hien visited Harsha** → Fa-Hien = Chandragupta II (~400).
5. **Hiuen Tsang = Fa-Hien** → ~630 vs ~400. 2024 order Fa-Hien first.
6. **I-Tsing sat in the 643 Kannauj assembly** → after Harsha.
7. **Nalanda founder = Xuanzang / Harsha** → **Kumaragupta I**. Xuanzang is the visitor.
8. **Sarvavarman issued the Gaya copper plate** → **2022 Q87 B**. Gaya plate = Gupta / Samudragupta. Sarvavarman = Asirgarh.
9. **Haraha = Sarvavarman** → **Ishanavarman**, Barabanki.
10. **Rajyashri married Dhruvasena II / Pulakeshin II** → **Grihavarman** only.
11. **Pulakeshin killed Rajyavardhana** → **Shashanka** of Gauda.
12. **Harsha conquered the Deccan** → **Narmada** stop. Aihole boast of Pulakeshin II.
13. **Aihole = Harsha’s prasasti** → **Ravikirti** for Pulakeshin II.
14. **Harshacharita = Si-Yu-Ki** → Bana’s Sanskrit vs Xuanzang’s Chinese.
15. **Kadambari = second Harsha chronicle** → romance. *Harshacharita* is the biography.
16. **Bana = Kalidasa** → Harsha court vs Gupta court.
17. **2018 Hathigumpha = Harsha** → **Kharavela**.
18. **2025 Battle of Kannauj = Harsha** → Humayun / Sher Shah.
19. **Prayag charity = 1540 war** → quinquennial give-away Xuanzang saw.
20. **Uparika invented by Harsha** → Gupta provincial title reused.
21. **Mathura = silk, Varanasi = cotton in Xuanzang** → reverse the pair.
22. **Yin-tu = a Harsha capital** → Chinese name for **India**.
23. **Tripartite struggle = Harsha vs Pulakeshin** → later Pala–Pratihara–Rashtrakuta for Kannauj.
24. **Shankaracharya’s four maths = Harsha foundations** → 8th-c. Advaita; not this file’s core.

25. **Sung-yun = Fa-Hien under CG II** → ~518 Wei envoy, not Chandragupta II.

Topic 11 — Ancient Indian Administration

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Rajan	Maharajadhiraja	Vedic chief vs Gupta/Harsha king of kings	राजन / महाराजाधिराज
Devanampiya	Vikramaditya	Ashoka on edicts vs Chandragupta II	देवानंप्रिय / विक्रमादित्य
Sabha	Samiti	Smaller/elder council vs larger tribal assembly	सभा / समिति
Bhagadugha	Akshavapa	Vedic revenue vs dice (2023 C)	भागदुघ / अक्षावाप
Bhagadugha	Samaharta	Vedic share-collector vs Mauryan chief collector	भागदुघ / समाहर्ता
Samaharta	Sannidhata	Collects vs stores	समाहर्ता / संनिधाता
Agronomai	Pautavadhyaksha	Megasthenes revenue vs weights	एग्रोनोमाई / पौतवाध्यक्ष
Rajuka	Uparika	Mauryan district land/justice vs Gupta province	राजुक / उपरिक
Sandhivigrahika	Mahasandhivigrahika	Gupta war-peace vs Harsha's maha- grade	संधिविग्रहिक / महा-
Hathigumpha	Prayag Prashasti	Kharavela vs Samudragupta	हाथीगुम्फा / प्रयाग
Ayodhya inscription	Besnagar	Pushyamitra ashwamedha vs Heliodorus	अयोध्या / बेसनगर
Gaya copper plate	Asirgarh seal	Samudragupta plate vs Maukhari Sarvavarman	गया / असीरगढ़

Books and Writers — Administration Sources

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Arthashastra</i> (अर्थशास्त्र)	Kautilya / Chanakya	Saptanga, adhyakshas, spies, revenue
<i>Indica</i>	Megasthenes (मेगस्थनीज)	Agronomai, city boards, seven classes

11.1 Ancient Rulers

Kind	Examples	use
Literary	Veda, Purana, Tripitaka, Sangam	doctrine, inflated king-lists
Epigraphy	edicts, Hathigumpha, Prayag, Nasik, Mehrauli	hardest dates and titles
Numismatics	punch-mark, Kushan gold, CG II silver	2022 Shaka-victory proof
Archaeology	sites, C-14, PGW / NBPW / IVC	period, not a king's name
Foreign accounts	Megasthenes, Fa-Hien, Xuanzang, I-tsing	2024 traveller order

Coins as administrative evidence

Coin type	Period / issuer	What it proves
Punch-marked silver (<i>karshapana</i>)	Mahajanapada → Maurya	Urban trade, magistrate control, weight standard
Mauryan cast copper	Mauryan	State issue beyond silver punch-marks
Indo-Greek portrait	Menander etc.	Die-struck bilingual (Greek + Kharoshthi) kings
Kushan gold	Vima / Kanishka	Imperial titles, Devaputra , long-distance trade
Satavahana lead / bronze	Deccan	Ship types = sea trade; metronymic legends
Gupta gold dinara	Samudragupta → Skandagupta	Imperial titles; Chandragupta II silver = western Shaka victory

Coin type	Period / issuer	What it proves
Restruck Nahapana silver	Gautamiputra age	Defeat of western Shaka overlord

11.8 Foreign Accounts on Ancient Administration

Traveller	Age	Admin observation
Megasthenes	Chandragupta Maurya	seven castes (Greek lens), agronomai, city boards
Fa-Hien	Chandragupta II	light punishments, Buddhist patronage visible
Hiuen Tsang	Harsha	good roads, hospices; elephant numbers = colour
I-tsing	Post-Harsha	monastic rules at Nalanda

UP Focus

Fact	Place
Ayodhya inscription	Pushyamitra ashwamedha
Prayag / Allahabad shaft	Ashoka + Harishena
Haraha	Barabanki — Ishanavarman
Jaunpur stone	Ishvaravarman
Bhitari	Ghazipur belt — Skandagupta
Banskhera	Shahjahanpur — Harsha signature
Besnagar	MP — Heliodorus pillar

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Both statements always true** → read each stem; Rahulovada-type distractors flip one statement.
2. **Jivitagupta–Deo-Baranark is the wrong Maukhari pair** → the wrong pair in that match set is **Sarvavarman–Gaya**.
3. **Bhagadugha = gambling** → **Akshavapa**. Bhagadugha = revenue.
4. **Agronomai = roads / weights** → **revenue** (2020).
5. **Hathigumpha = Harsha / Ashoka / Kanishka** → **Kharavela**.
6. **Pushyamitra ashwamedha = Besnagar / Hathigumpha** → **Ayodhya**.
7. **Vikramaditya = Samudragupta** → **Chandragupta II**.
8. **Devanampiya = Gupta title** → **Ashoka**.
9. **Samaharta = treasurer** → **Sannidhata** stores. Samaharta collects.
10. **Uparika = Mauryan district** → Gupta/Harsha **province**.
11. **Gaya plate = Sarvavarman** → **Samudragupta**. Sarvavarman = Asirgarh.
12. **Start the Gupta line at Chandragupta II** → Sri Gupta → Ghatotkacha → **Chandragupta I**.
13. **Vayu Purana = Gupta admin** → 2023 stmt 2 false.
14. **Allahabad pillar is only Gupta** → Ashokan shaft reused.
15. **Aihole = Harsha's prasasti** → **Ravikirti** for Pulakeshin II.
16. **Guptas more central than Mauryas** → opposite.
17. **Dhananjaya = Avamukta** → **Kusthalapura**.
18. **Sabha = Mauryan board** → Vedic assembly.

Topic 12 — Ancient Indian Economy

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Punch-marked	Gupta dinara	First silver coins vs later gold prestige	पंच-मार्क / दीनार
Dinara	Rupaka	Gupta gold vs CG II silver (~33 grains)	दीनार / रूपक
Nishka	Karshapana	Vedic gold unit vs punch-marked coin	निष्क / कार्षापण
Shreni	Manigrama	General craft guild vs foreign trade (2018)	श्रेणी / मणिग्राम
Nanadesi	Manigrama	Merchants of many lands vs overseas Manigrama	नानादेशी / मणिग्राम
Lothal	Muziris	Harappan dock vs Sangam–Roman pepper port	लोथल / मुज़िरिस
Barygaza	Barbarikon	Broach vs Indus-mouth in Periplus	भरूच / बारबारिकोन
Tamralipti	Broach	East Ganga mouth vs west Narmada mouth	ताम्रलिप्ति / भरूच
Uttarapatha	Dakshinapatha	NW–Ganga highway vs north– Deccan	उत्तरापथ / दक्षिणापथ
Port	Entrepot	Landing point vs warehouse / redistributor	बंदरगाह / एंट्रेपो
Urban	Pastoral	IVC (2020) vs Rigvedic	नगरीय / पशुपालक

Books and Writers — Economy Sources

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Periplus of the Erythraean Sea</i>	Anonymous Greek merchant	1st c. CE sailing handbook; Barygaza / Muziris
Natural History (gold-drain note)	Pliny	Roman gold flowing to India
<i>Arthashastra</i>	Kautilya (कौटिल्य)	Guild custom, revenue, Mauryan economy

12.1 Economy

Match spine

- The Indus Valley economy is keyed as **urban**.
- The Rigvedic economy is keyed as **pastoral**.
- The Later Vedic economy is keyed as **agrarian**.
- The medieval slot in the 2020 match list is **landlordism**.

12.10 Punch-Marked Coins — Symbols and Janapadas

Fact	Detail
Metal / name	Silver karshapana with several punch symbols
Issuers	First mahajanapadas , then Magadha–Maurya
Small change	Mauryan cast copper <i>kakani</i>
Style	Geometric / animal punches — no royal portrait
Portraits	Begin with Indo-Greek (इंडो-ग्रीक) die-struck coins

UP Focus

Fact	Place
Varanasi	Inland textile / Ganga river-port
Kaushambi	Uttarapatha Ganga node
Kannauj	Later entrepot (Harsha age)
Alamgirpur	IVC east end. Not a sea-port
Lothal / Muziris	Not UP

Common Traps — Facts

1. **First Indian coins = Gupta gold → punch-marked silver.**
2. **2022 Shaka proof = dinara → silver**, ~33 grains.
3. **33 grains = gold weight** → silver rupaka. Gold is ~120–144.
4. **King-queen gold = Chandragupta II → Chandragupta I.**
5. **Lyrist = Chandragupta II → Samudragupta.**
6. **Nishka = Mauryan coin** → Vedic gold **unit**.
7. **Shreni = 2018 foreign trade → Manigramam.**
8. **Shreni = only northern India** → north **and** south; quality/price/conduct are guild-controlled.
9. **Nanadesi = Manigramam** → many-lands vs overseas guild.
10. **Boat models = Dholavira → Mohenjo-daro + Lothal.**
11. **Barbarikon = Broach** → Indus mouth. Broach = **Barygaza**.
12. **Tamralipti = main Roman port** → **Muziris** / west-south.
13. **Lothal = Muziris** → Bronze Age dock vs Sangam–Roman pepper.
14. **IVC = pastoral** → **Urban** (2020). Pastoral = Rigvedic.
15. **Later Vedic = urban** → **agrarian**.
16. **Entrepot = any jetty** → warehouse / redistributor.
17. **Dakshinapatha = only sea** → inland north–Deccan road.
18. **Yavana = only a Greek king** → Sangam foreign / western trader.
19. **Only the first statement true** → check whether **both** statements hold before locking “Only 1”.

Topic 13 — Archaeology

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Site	Excavation	Place with remains vs the dig	स्थल / उत्खनन
Stratigraphy	C-14	Relative (layers) vs calendar years	स्तरिकी / कार्बन-14
Relative	Absolute	Older/younger vs 5730-year clock	सापेक्ष / निरपेक्ष
Marshall	Wheeler	Announces IVC 1924 vs grid dig 1946	मार्शल / व्हीलर
Sahni	Banerjee	Harappa 1921 vs Mohenjo-daro 1922	साहनी / बनर्जी
Wakankar	Sankalia	Bhimbetka vs Deccan prehistory	वाकणकर / संकलिया
Alamgirpur	Rakhigarhi	Easternmost UP vs largest Haryana	आलमगीरपुर / राखीगढ़ी
Mandi	Manda	Muzaffarnagar UP vs J&K Chenab	मंडी / मांडा
Hulas	Lothal	Baghpat UP vs Gujarat dock	हुलास / लोथल
Rock shelter	Cave	Bhimbetka overhang vs hollow	शैल आश्रय / गुफा
ASI HQ	Lucknow	New Delhi vs UP state archaeology	दिल्ली / लखनऊ

13.5 Archaeological Sites

Site	State
Nevasa	Maharashtra (Pravara)
Isampur	Karnataka (Acheulian)
Didwana	Rajasthan (थार) (Thar fringe)
Gudiyam Cave	Tamil Nadu

13.6 Archaeological Sites of Uttar Pradesh

Site	District / river	Fact
Alamgirpur	Meerut, Hindon	Easternmost IVC site in India
Hulas	Baghpat	UP Harappan; PYQs 2018, 2020, 2025
Mandi	Bijnor, Ramganga (रामगंगा)	UP Harappan (2021, 2025)
Often used as bait	Actual location	
-----	-----	
Manda	Jammu and Kashmir	
Rakhigarhi	Haryana (largest IVC mound in India)	
Kalibangan	Rajasthan	
Lothal	Gujarat	
Balu	Haryana	

13.7 Archaeological Cultures — Pottery and Metal Horizons

Culture	Marker	Usual date / link
OCP (Ochre Coloured Pottery)	eastern doab pottery	Chalcolithic overlap; pairs with copper hoards
PGW (Painted Grey Ware)	grey painted bowls	Later Vedic north; Hastinapur, Atranjikhhera
NBPW (Northern Black Polished Ware)	lustrous northern fine ware	~6th c. BCE rise; Mauryan cities
Megalithic	burials with big stones	Iron-age south ; not Harappan

13.8 Major Excavation Sites — Signature Cards

Site	State	Excavator / fact	Signature find
Rakhigarhi	Haryana	recent ASI digs	largest IVC mound in India; not UP
Dholavira	Gujarat	R.S. Bisht	reservoirs, signboard , stone architecture
Kalibangan	Rajasthan	B.B. Lal	ploughed field, fire altars
Banawali	Haryana	—	fortified Harappan town
Surkotada	Gujarat	—	Harappan fort; horse-bone debate

13.9 Dating Methods — Beyond C-14

Method	Samples	Fact
Stratigraphy	soil layers	relative order only
Typology	pottery shape	relative, cross-site
Radiocarbon (C-14)	charcoal, bone, seed	organic only; ~5730 yr half-life
Thermoluminescence (TL)	fired pottery, bricks	when object was last heated

UP Focus

Trap	Fact
Bhimbetka in UP	MP
ASI HQ Lucknow	New Delhi
Sanauli = Mature Harappan dock	Late Harappan / OCP chariots , Baghpat

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Rakhigarhi** = **UP** → **Haryana**. 2025 bait.
2. **Biggest IVC** = **eastern boundary** → east end is **Alamgirpur**.
3. **Mandi** = **Manda** → Bijnor UP vs **J&K**.
4. **Hulas** = **Gujarat** → **Baghpat, UP**. Padri is Gujarat.
5. **Kalibangan / Lothal** = **UP** → Rajasthan / Gujarat (2018).
6. **Wheeler discovered IVC** → Sahni + Banerjee under **Marshall 1924**. Wheeler = 1946 grid.
7. **Marshall dug every trench** → he is the **DG** who announced.
8. **Wakankar** = **Vatsa** → Vatsa is Harappan. Wakankar = **Bhimbetka**.
9. **Bhimbetka** = **UP** → **MP**.

10. **C-14** dates stone / copper → **organic** only.
11. **ASI HQ** = **Lucknow** → **New Delhi**.
12. **Sanauli** = **Lothal dock** → Baghpat **chariots**, Late Harappan / OCP.
13. **Didwana** = **Tamil Nadu** → **Rajasthan**. Gudiya = TN.
14. **Isampur** = **Maharashtra** → **Karnataka**. Nevasa = MH.
15. **Manda** = **eastern Harappan** → **north** (J&K). East = Alamgirpur.

Topic 14 — Ancient India Miscellaneous

Confused Pairs

A	B	Difference	Hindi
Mesopotamia	Egypt	Two rivers + city-states vs one Nile + unified pharaoh	मेसोपोटामिया / मिस्र
Ziggurat	Pyramid	Stepped temple vs royal tomb	जिगुरात / पिरामिड
Cuneiform	Hieroglyphs	Clay wedges vs picture signs	कीलाक्षर / चित्रलिपि
Indus script	Oracle bones	Still unread vs earliest readable Chinese	सिन्धु लिपि / अस्थि लेख
Mahapurana	Upapurana	18 major (5 traits) vs 18 minor	महापुराण / उपपुराण
Vishnu Purana	Vayu Purana	Mauryan list vs not Gupta admin	विष्णु / वायु
Matsya Purana	Vishnu Purana	Longest Andhra / Satavahana list vs Mauryan genealogy	मत्स्य / विष्णु
Ikshvaku	Vakataka	Puranic Shriparvatiya vs Vidarbha	इक्ष्वाकु / वाकाटक
Charvaka	Charaka	Materialist school vs Ayurveda compiler	चार्वाक / चरक
Charvaka	Buddhism	Denies rebirth vs accepts karma/rebirth	चार्वाक / बौद्ध
Kakatiya	Yadava	Warangal vs Devagiri	काकतीय / यादव
Warangal	Hanamkonda	Fort capital vs Thousand Pillar town	वारंगल / हनमकोंडा
Ganapati	Rudrama	Peak expander vs queen (his daughter)	गणपतिदेव / रुद्रमा
Rudrama	Prataparudra II	Female monarch vs last king, fall 1323	रुद्रमा / प्रतापरुद्र
Ramappa	Thousand Pillar	Palampet UNESCO 2021 vs Hanamkonda	रामप्पा / सहस्र स्तंभ
Jayaswal	Smith	<i>Hindu Polity</i> vs <i>Early History of India</i>	जयसवाल / स्मिथ
Kosambi	Basham	Marxist <i>Introduction</i> vs cultural <i>Wonder</i>	कोसांबी / बैशम
Charaka	Sushruta	Internal medicine 120/8 vs surgery	चरक / सुश्रुत

Books and Writers — Miscellaneous

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
<i>Hindu Polity</i>	K.P. Jayaswal	Nationalist gana / polity reading
<i>The Wonder That Was India</i>	A.L. Basham	Cultural survey
<i>An Introduction to the Study of Indian History</i>	D.D. Kosambi	Marxist / analytical history
<i>The Early History of India</i>	Vincent Arthur Smith	Colonial dynastic narrative
<i>Charaka Samhita</i>	Charaka (चरक) (Agnivesha redaction)	Internal medicine; 120 chapters / 8 sthanas
<i>Sushruta Samhita</i> (सुश्रुत संहिता)	Sushruta	Surgery / rhinoplasty tradition

14.2 Civilizations and their Characteristics

Trait	Mesopotamia	Egypt	Harappan	Shang
River	Tigris–Euphrates	Nile	Indus–Ghaggar	Yellow River
Polity	City-states → empires	Unified pharaoh	Urban centres, king unnamed	King + clans
Script	Cuneiform (read)	Hieroglyphs (read)	Indus (unread)	Oracle bones (read)
Monument	Ziggurat	Pyramid	Great Bath, granaries	Bronze ritual set

Trait	Mesopotamia	Egypt	Harappan	Shang
Economy	Temple + long-distance trade	Nile grain	Agri + craft + Meluhha trade	Agri + bronze elite
Religion	Many gods, Enuma Elish	Divine king, afterlife	Unresolved (Pashupati debate)	Ancestors + Di
End-note	Conquest replacement	Dynastic continuity	De-urbanisation ~1900 BCE	Zhou conquest

14.3 Puranas

Mark	Meaning
Sarga	Creation
Pratisarga	Dissolution / recreation
Vamsha	Gods-and-sages genealogy
Manvantara	Manu-ages / cosmic cycles
Vamshanucharita	Royal dynasties (the history bit)

18 Mahapuranas (match list)

#	Purana	Usual sect-tag
1	Brahma	Brahma
2	Padma	Vishnu
3	Vishnu	Vishnu — Mauryan list
4	Shiva	Shiva
5	Bhagavata	Vishnu / Krishna bhakti
6	Narada	Vishnu
7	Markandeya	Devi Mahatmya sits here
8	Agni	Encyclopaedic (weapons, vastu)
9	Bhavishya	Mixed / later layers
10	Brahmavaivarta	Krishna
11	Linga	Shiva
12	Varaha	Vishnu
13	Skanda	Shiva — largest, tirtha-heavy
14	Vamana	Vishnu
15	Kurma	Vishnu
16	Matsya	Vishnu — flood + dynastic lists
17	Garuda	Vishnu — shraddha / afterlife
18	Brahmanda	Brahma

Purana → dynasty (history use)

Purana	Dynasty it is asked for	What it preserves
Vishnu Purana (विष्णु पुराण)	Maurya (मौर्य)	Maurya genealogy. The same Magadha chain also names Nanda, Shunga, and Kanva.
Matsya Purana (मत्स्य पुराण)	Andhra / Satavahana (सातवाहन)	Longest Andhra list, about 30 kings and about 460 years.

Purana	Dynasty it is asked for	What it preserves
Vayu Purana (वायु पुराण)	Gupta (गुप्त) <i>kings</i>	Gupta names . Also the Kanva end and Andhra founder Simuka (सिमुक). It is not a Gupta admin manual.
Brahmanda Purana (ब्रह्माण्ड पुराण)	Parallel to Vayu	Andhra and Gupta name-lists sit close to the Vayu recension.
Bhagavata Purana (भागवत पुराण)	Solar–lunar lines + Krishna	Also carries Maurya–Andhra lists. It is the Krishna-bhakti peak text.
Bhavishya Purana (भविष्य पुराण)	“Future” Kali-age kings	Later layers. Use it lightly.
Markandeya Purana (मार्कण्डेय पुराण)	Not a dynasty match	<i>Devi Mahatmya</i> (देवी माहात्म्य) sits here.
Skanda Purana (स्कन्द पुराण)	Not a dynasty match	Largest Maha. Tirtha geography, not the Magadha king-list.

14.5 Kakatiya Dynasty

Capital match

Dynasty	Capital
Pallava	Kanchi (कांची)
Pandya	Madura (Madurai)
Yadava (Seuna)	Devagiri
Kakatiya	Warangal

Warangal name trap

- Pair **Warangal** — **Ramchandra Dev** is **NOT** correctly matched.
- **Ramachandra** is the **Yadava** king of **Devagiri** (the man Alauddin squeezed).
- Warangal’s last Kakatiya is **Prataparudra**, not Ramachandra.

Logic: Warangal in Alauddin’s **conquest chronology** is a **Sultanate** question. The fact here is only: Deccan raid hits **Kakatiya Warangal** after the Rajput forts.

Common Traps — Facts

1. **Vayu Purana** = **Gupta administration** → false. 2023 Q29 Only 1.
2. **Shriparvatiya** = **Vakataka** → **Ikshvaku** (Nagarjunakonda).
3. **Purana Qila** = a **Mahapurana** → Delhi **fort**.
4. **Harappan script** = **readable hieroglyphs** → still **unread**.
5. **Ziggurat** = **pyramid** → temple tower vs **tomb**.
6. **Kakatiya capital** = **Devagiri** → **Warangal**. Devagiri = Yadava.
7. **Warangal** = **Ramchandra Dev** → 2018 bait. Ramachandra = **Yadava**.
8. **Prataparudra** founded **Kakatiyas** → he is the **last** (1323).
9. **Rudrama** = **Chola / Hoysala** → **Kakatiya**, daughter of Ganapati.
10. **Thousand Pillar** = **Palampet / inside the fort** → **Hanamkonda**.
11. **Ramappa** = **Karnataka / Andhra** → **Telangana**, UNESCO 2021.
12. **Charvaka** wrote **Charaka Samhita** → physician vs materialist.

13. **Charaka = 100 chapters / 5 sections → 120 / 8.**
14. **Kosambi wrote *Early History of India* → Smith.** Kosambi = *Introduction to the Study*.
15. **Basham = Marxist historian** → cultural survey. Marxist fact = **Kosambi**.
16. **Buddhism = Charvaka** → Buddhism keeps **rebirth**.
17. **Nyaya = Kanada** → Nyaya = **Gautama**. Kanada = Vaisheshika.
18. **Kakatiyas ruled the UP doab → Telangana.**
19. **Meluhha = Egypt** → Mesopotamia's name for the **Indus** land.
20. **Independent Kakatiyas till 1687** → end **1323**. 1687 is Golconda.

Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Prehistoric & Protohistoric UK

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
Lakhudiyar (Lakhu Cave)	Barechhina, Almora (अल्मोड़ा) on the Suyal river ; discovered 1968 by Dr. M. P. Joshi ; red, black, white motifs
Gwarkha Udyar	Dungri village, Chamoli (चमोली) on Alaknanda river ; discovered by Rakesh Bhatt; vivid red animal depictions
Hudli Rock Art	Uttarkashi (उत्तरकाशी) on Kamal river; unique for blue colour rock paintings
Kimni Village	Chamoli (Pindar valley); light white colour depictions of weapons and cattle
Luethap	Almora; human figures painted in blood-red colour in group dancing postures
Falsima	Almora; humans depicted in yogic and dancing postures ; prehistoric cup-marks (<i>Okhal</i>)
Phadkanauli & Petshal	Almora; discovered by Dr. Yashodhar Mathpal (1989–90); ochre dance motifs
Malari Excavations	Chamoli ; investigated by S. P. Dabral (1956) and Garhwal University (1983, 2001)
Malari Master Finds	5.2 kg gold face mask , complete skeleton of Himalayan Zebu bull, Swat-style pottery
Bankot Copper Hoard	Pithoragarh (पिथौरागढ़); 8 copper anthropomorphs (humanoid figures) discovered in 1989
Bahadabad (Haridwar)	Excavated 1951–53 by Y. D. Sharma ; Copper Hoards and Ochre-Coloured Pottery (OCP)
Naula Jainal (Almora)	Megalithic cist-burials discovered by Dr. M. P. Joshi

Master Table of Prehistoric Rock Art Sites in Uttarakhand

Site Name	District & River Basin	Discovered By / Year	Distinguishing Visual & Stylistic Features
Lakhudiyar (Lakhu Udyar)	Almora (Barechhina, Suyal river)	Dr. M. P. Joshi (1968)	Largest rock shelter. 3 colours: red, black, white. Humans in interlocking finger dancing chain; lizard-like animals; wavy lines.
Gwarkha Udyar	Chamoli (Dungri village, Alaknanda)	Rakesh Bhatt	Vivid, well-preserved depictions of human hunters, sheep, mountain goats, and deer painted in bold ochre.
Kimni Village	Chamoli (Tharali, Pindar river)	State Archaeology Survey	Distinctive light white chalk/lime paintings depicting spears, daggers, bows, arrows, and livestock.
Luethap	Almora (near Almora town)	Regional Survey	Figures rendered in striking blood-red colour ; depiction of humans driving animals into traps and hand-in-hand dance.
Hudli	Uttarkashi (Kamal river valley)	State Archaeology Survey	Blue colour rock inscriptions and geometric animal paintings (unique in the Central Himalaya).
Falsima	Almora (near Phadkanauli)	Regional Survey	Humans depicted in Yogic postures (<i>Asanas</i>) and ritual dance circles; cup-marks cut into rock slabs.
Phadkanauli	Almora (Barechhina-Danya road)	Dr. Yashodhar Mathpal (1989)	Three painted rock shelters with reddish-brown deer and human scenes.
Petshal	Almora (between Barechhina & Danya)	Dr. Yashodhar Mathpal (1990)	Ochre-coloured dancing human figures in ceremonial rows.
Kasardevi Cave	Almora (Crank’s Ridge)	Prehistoric shelter	Cup-marks and prehistoric incisions; later site of Swami Vivekananda’s meditation (1890).

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Lakhudiyar vs Gwarkha	Lakhudiyar = Almora (Suyal river) , M. P. Joshi; Gwarkha = Chamoli (Alaknanda river) , Dungri village.
Hudli vs Kimni	Hudli = blue colour paintings (Uttarkashi); Kimni = light white colour paintings (Chamoli).
Malari vs Burzahom	Malari = Chamoli (gold mask, cist burial, Zebu bull); Burzahom = Kashmir (Neolithic pit-dwellings, dog burial).
Bankot vs Bahadrabad	Bankot = Pithoragarh (8 copper anthropomorphs); Bahadrabad = Haridwar (OCP and copper celts).
Kalsi Ashokan Edict Language	Language is Prakrit ; script is Brahmi (trap: not Sanskrit or Kharoshthi).

Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Ancient Tribes

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
Earliest Inhabitants	Kol (Munda) — identified by Dr. S. P. Dabral; totemism, snake/linga worship
Epic Himalayan Tribe	Kirat — defeated Kols; Shiva tested Arjuna in Kirat guise at Bilvakedar; direct descendants: Raji
Dominant Ancient Race	Khas — entered via Central Asia/Kashmir; classified as degraded Kshatriyas in Manusmriti
Khas Customary Laws	Ghar-Javai , Tekwa (levirate/widow retaining companion), Jethon (extra share to eldest son)
Shaka Presence Proof	Sun Temples across Uttarakhand (Katarmal Sun Temple Almora, Palothi, Madh)
ST Notification Year	1967 — Government of India notified 5 Scheduled Tribes in Uttarakhand
Largest ST by Population	Tharu (Udham Singh Nagar: Khatima, Sitarganj); celebrate Diwali as Shok Parva (Mourning)
2nd Largest ST	Jaunsari (Dehradun: Chakrata, Kalsi, Tyuni); polyandry tradition; Mahasu Devta worship
Trans-Himalayan Traders	Bhotia (Johar, Darma, Byans, Niti, Mana); transhumance; ancient Indo-Tibetan barter trade
Smallest ST Population	Raji (Van Rawat / Jungle Kings) of Pithoragarh; cave dwellings (<i>Rauthiyada</i>); silent trade
Teraï Tribe	Buksa (Bhoksa) of Buksad (Bazpur, Kashipur, Ramnagar); claim descent from Mewar Rajputs

Modern Scheduled Tribes of Uttarakhand (Notified 1967)

Scheduled Tribe	Primary Concentration	Cultural & Religious Hallmarks	High-Yield Prelims Hooks
Tharu	Udham Singh Nagar (Khatima, Sitarganj, Kichha)	Matriarchal influence (women hold supreme domestic authority). Worship <i>Khadga Bhoot</i> , <i>Pachhim-Rukh</i> . Celebrate <i>Bajhar</i> festival.	Largest ST in UK (~33% of tribal pop). Celebrate Diwali as Shok Parva (Mourning). Traditional alcoholic beverage: Jand .
Jaunsari	Dehradun (Chakrata, Kalsi, Tyuni / Jaunsar-Bawar)	Polyandry (<i>Draupadi Vivah</i> , fraternal polyandry). Supreme deity: Mahasu Devta (Hanol Temple on Tons river).	2nd Largest ST in UK. Festivals: Bissu (Baisakhi), Magh Mela (animal sacrifice / Maroj). Folk dances: Barada Nati (बरदा नाटी), Harul, Thandya.
Bhotia	Chamoli, Pithoragarh, Uttarkashi	Mongoloid descent. Divided into sub-groups: Johari, Darmiya, Byansi, Chaudansi, Tolchha, Marchha, Jad . High-altitude transhumance.	Ancient Trans-Himalayan wool & salt trade with Western Tibet (<i>Huniyas</i>) terminated after 1962 Sino-Indian War. Traditional drink: Chhang . Winter home: <i>Gunda/Munsa</i> ; Summer home: <i>Mait</i> .
Buksa (Bhoksa)	US Nagar (Bazpur, Kashipur), Dehradun, Nainital (<i>Buksad</i> belt)	Claim royal descent from Udaipur/Mewar Rajputs who fled after Mughal invasions. Worship Chamunda Devi (Chaiti Mela at Kashipur).	Patriarchal families; Council head called Takhat assisted by <i>Munsif</i> (मुंसिफ़) and <i>Daroga</i> .
Raji (Van Rawat)	Pithoragarh (Didihat, Dharchula, Champawat fringe)	Traditionally nomadic cave dwellers (<i>Rauthiyada</i>); worship <i>Nandadevi</i> , <i>Ghananad</i> , and forest spirits.	Smallest ST in UK (< 1,000 persons). Historically practiced Silent Barter Trade (Mook Vyapar) . Language: Tibo-Burman / Munda dialect .

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Tharu vs Buksa	Tharu = Largest ST (matriarchal lean, Diwali as mourning); Buksa = Udaipur Rajput descent , Chaiti Mela at Kashipur.

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Marchha / Tolchha vs Jad	Marchha & Tolchha = Bhotia sub-clans in Chamoli (Niti/Mana) ; Jad = Bhotia sub-clan in Uttarkashi (Jadhung/Nelang) practicing Buddhism.
Hanol Temple vs Katarmal Temple	Hanol (Tons river) = Supreme shrine of Mahasu Devta (Jaunsari) ; Katarmal (Almora) = 9th-century Sun Temple (Shaka influence) .
Raji vs Tharu Population	Tharu is the most numerous ST (~33%); Raji is the least numerous ST (< 1%).
Bissu vs Baisakhi	Bissu is the Jaunsari festival celebrated on Baisakhi featuring traditional archery (<i>Thoda</i>) dance.

Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Kuninda & Yaudheya

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
First Historic Dynasty	Kuninda (Kulinda) — ruled central Himalayan foothills from 2nd cent. BCE to 3rd cent. CE
Epic Identity	Mentioned in Mahabharata; King Subahu of Subahupur (Srinagar); hailed as Dwij Srestha
Greatest Monarch	Amoghbhuti (1st century BCE) — issued bi-scriptural silver and copper coinage
Amoghbhuti Coins	Obverse: Brahmi ; Reverse: Kharoshthi (खरोष्ठी); motifs: Goddess Lakshmi, deer, tree in railing
Almora Type Coins	8 rulers: Shivdatt, Shivpalit, Haridatt, Gomitra, Aashadh, Mrigbhuti, Vijayabhuti
Chhatreshwar Type Coins	Dedicated to Lord Shiva (Chhatreshwar) holding trident; legend: <i>Bhagavata Chhatreshwara</i>
Yaudheya Republic	Martial <i>Ayudhajivi Gana</i> ; coin hoards found at Jaunsar-Bawar, Bhadraj, and Lansdowne
Yaudheya Coin Motifs	Lord Karttikeya (with peacock) and Goddess Devsena; legend: <i>"Yaudheya Ganasya Jaya"</i>
Brahmapura Kingdom	6th–7th cent. kingdom recorded by Hiuen Tsang; ruled by Paurava / Vrishavardhan dynasty
Taleshwar Copper Plates	Found in Almora (अल्मोड़ा); record grants of Paurava kings (Dvijavardhan, Vishnuvardhan) to God Biraneswar

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Amoghbhuti vs Chhatreshwar	Amoghbhuti = personal king's name (silver + copper); Chhatreshwar = religious dedication to Lord Shiva (copper).
Almora Type vs Amoghbhuti Type	Almora type = Brahmi only (8 local king names); Amoghbhuti type = bi-scriptural (Brahmi + Kharoshthi).
Brahmapura vs Kartikeyapur	Brahmapura = 6th–7th century kingdom (Taleshwar plates, Hiuen Tsang); Kartikeyapur = 8th–11th century Katyuri capital (Bajjnath).
Yaudheya vs Kuninda	Yaudheya = warrior gana / republic (Karttikeya); Kuninda = foothill monarchical/tribal state (Lakshmi & deer).
Taleshwar vs Pandukeshwar	Taleshwar (Almora) = Paurava dynasty plates ; Pandukeshwar (Chamoli) = Katyuri dynasty plates .

Uttarakhand — Topic 4 — Kartikepur Dynasty

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	Key Fact
Dynasty Name	Kartikepur / Katyuri — first historic imperial kingdom of Uttarakhand (c. 740 CE to 1050 CE)
First Capital	Joshimath (Kartikeyapura) in the Alaknanda valley (Garhwal)
Second Capital	Bajjnath (Katyur Valley) on the Gomti river in Bageshwar (Kumaon)
Founder Tradition	Basantandev (Basu Dev) — assumed title <i>Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja</i>
Primary Epigraphic Record	Bageshwar Inscription of King Bhuwandev & 4 Pandukeshwar Copper Plates
The Great Unifier	Ishtaganadeva — first monarch to politically unify entire Garhwal and Kumaon
Most Powerful Monarch	Lalitsuradeva — compared to Varaha and Bhagiratha in Pandukeshwar plates
Three Dynastic Houses	1. Basantandev House \rightarrow 2. Nimbar House \rightarrow 3. Salonaditya House
Tyrannical Last King	Bir Dev (Biram Dev) — notoriously tyrannical; overthrown by local uprising
Post-Katyuri Branches	Fragmented into Askot (Rajbars), Doti (Raiykas), Dwarahat, and Bajjnath
Official Language & Script	Official/epigraphic language: Sanskrit; Script: Kutila / Siddhamatrika

The Three Dynastic Families of the Katyuris

Detailed Ruler Matrix & Achievements

Dynastic House	Rulers	High-Yield Prelims Milestones
First Family (House of Basantandev)	Basantandev (Founder), Kharparadeva, Kalyanrajadeva, Tribhuwanrajadeva	Basantandev founded the house around 740 CE. Mentioned in Bageshwar stone inscription as donating <i>Swarnakeshwar</i> village to a temple. Tribhuwanrajadeva made grants to God Vyaghreswar.
Second Family (House of Nimbar)	Nimbar, Ishtaganadeva, Lalitsuradeva, Bhuwandev	Nimbar: Zealous devotee of Shiva; built rock-cut shrines. Ishtaganadeva: Succeeded Nimbar; unified entire Uttarakhand (Kumaon and Garhwal); built Lakuli-Shiva and Navadurga temples. Lalitsuradeva: Son of Ishtaganadeva and Queen Vegadevi; 44-year reign; issued 2 Pandukeshwar plates. Bhuwandev: Endowed Bageshwar temple with revenues of several villages.
Third Family (House of Salonaditya)	Salonaditya, Ichhata Deva, Deshatadeva, Padmata, Subhiksharaja	Succeeded after civil strife. Replaced the capital at <i>Subhikshapura</i> . Inscribed Pandukeshwar copper plates dating to early 11th century.

Administrative Matrix & Official Hierarchy of the Katyuris

Sanskrit Official Title	Exact Portfolio / Administrative Function
Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja	Supreme title assumed by the Katyuri Sovereign.
Mahasamanta (महासामंत)	Semi-autonomous feudatory prince or chief commander.
Kottapala	Military commandant in charge of frontier forts and mountain passes.
Doshaparadhika	High-level investigative officer responsible for apprehending thieves, rebels, and felons.
Dandapashika / Dandanayaka	Criminal magistrate and executioner enforcing penal justice.
Bhogika / Mahabhogika	High revenue officer responsible for collecting the king's share of grain and cattle (<i>Bhoga</i>).

Sanskrit Official Title	Exact Portfolio / Administrative Function
Saulkika	Toll and customs collection officer positioned along mountain transit points.
Tarika / Ghattapala	Officer supervising river ferries, boats, and bridge crossings.
Khadgika	Royal personal bodyguard armed with the royal sword.
Pratihara / Mahapratihara	Chief Palace Chamberlain regulating entry into the royal presence.
Kishorvadhikrit	Officer looking after royal mares, horses, and studs.

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Kartikeyapura vs Brahmapura	Kartikeyapura = Katyuri capital (Joshimath \rightarrow Baijnath); Brahmapura = 6th–7th century regional entity in Hiuen Tsang / Taleshwar plates.
Basantandev vs Ishtaganadeva	Basantandev = Founder of Katyuri state; Ishtaganadeva = Unifier of both Garhwal and Kumaon.
Bageshwar Inscription vs Pandukeshwar Plates	Bageshwar = Stone inscription of Bhuwandev ; Pandukeshwar = 4 Copper plates (Lalitsuradeva, Padmata, Subhiksharajadeva).
Bir Dev vs Somchand	Bir Dev = Last tyrannical Katyuri king ; Somchand = Founder of Chand dynasty who succeeded the Katyuris in Kali Kumaon.
Doshaparadhika vs Dandapashika	Doshaparadhika = Investigative officer (detective); Dandapashika = Penal enforcer (punishment magistrate).